TRANSFORMING CUSTOMER JOURNEYS
Playbook

Journey Team Setup

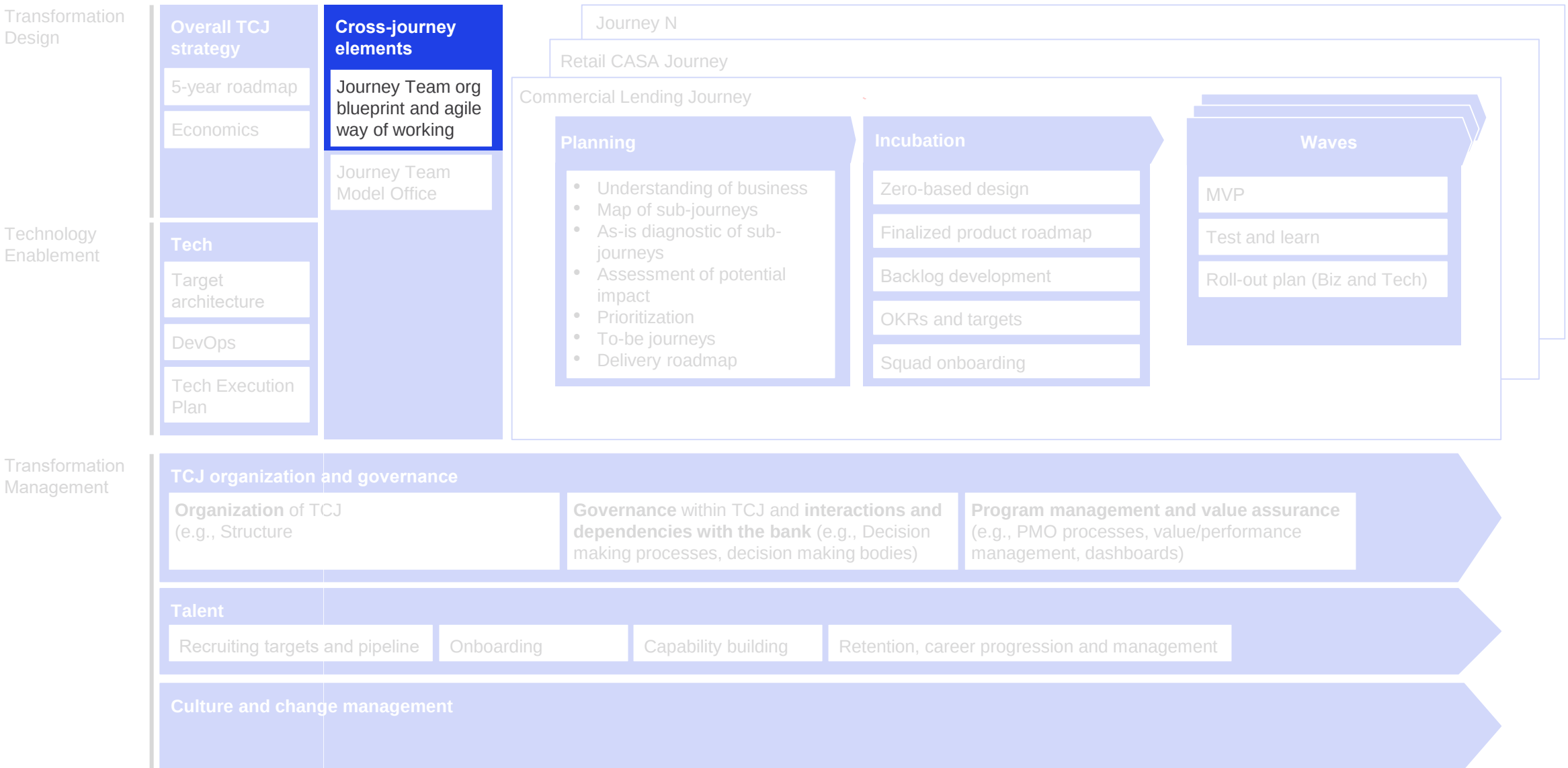
Journey Team org blueprint and agile way of working

This playbook contains all the pieces and parts that make up our approach to transforming customer journeys. This is a living document and the latest version can be found on TCJ's Confluence site.

Last updated in May 2019

CIMB

How this module fits into overall TCJ Playbook



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What is the agile operating model that each Journey Team uses?

- **Overview: Role of each Journey Team undergoes**
- Journey Team Org Blueprint
- Journey Team agile way of working
- Journey Team ceremonies / cadence

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The journey transformation is delivered over three phases: Planning, Incubation and Waves

	2 months	2 months	4 waves x 3 months each	
Journey Phases	**A. Planning**	**B. Incubation**	**C. Waves**	
			Build and Pilot	Roll in and scale
Activity	▪ Initial analysis based on internal and external sources of insight ▪ Process diagnostic ▪ Revenue and cost baselining ▪ Identify and detailing of key interventions ▪ Refine bottom-up impact estimates ▪ Planning and road-mapping	▪ Build collective understanding of the current journey from customers perspective ▪ 'Zero based design' based on informed leadership choice ▪ Identify and validate the levers for change ▪ Business case definition backed with empirical data ▪ Planning and road-mapping	▪ Build the 'minimum viable solution' (tech or non-tech) ▪ Deploy, test and learn and iterate with customers ▪ Prepare to scale	▪ Roll in volume and people into the Lab ▪ New features and product improvements developed in agile way and released regularly ▪ IT industrialisation
Outcome	▪ Initial blueprint for prioritized journeys: – As-is journey, pain points/ opportunities – KPI definition & potential impact assessment – High-level implementation plan/ investments ▪ Final product roadmap with overall plan by waves ▪ Harmonized portfolio of initiatives (between TCJ and BAU) ▪ Target IT architecture ▪ High-level technology buildout plan	▪ Target state re-design of journey including principles and customer vision ▪ Roadmap of change ▪ Validation of hypothesis through customer insight / research ▪ Target IT architecture ▪ Target operations operating model and policies (incl. conduct/credit risk)	▪ Evidence of new leadership behaviours / ways of working ▪ Validated learning on baseline benefits, feasibility and customer benefits	▪ Functioning journey with supporting technology ops model ▪ Model Office model to scale new operations process to BAU ▪ Metrics and tracking ▪ Aligned leadership purpose

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Detailed methodology and template included in Journey Guide Playbooks

A. The Planning phase sets the context and the requirements for the launch of the transformation

Key workstreams	A1. Establishing the baseline for transformation	A2. Validating the feasibility of the vision	A3. Prepare to launch the incubation Lab
Activities	▪ Identify and obtain existing inputs ▪ Draft charter, iterate throughout phase ▪ Map customer journey, value stream ▪ Perform rapid diagnostic ▪ Begin customer research (ongoing throughout transformation)	▪ Interview experts ▪ Map IT architecture, op model, processes, and resources supporting proposition ▪ Review existing programmes ▪ Review regulatory, legal requirements	▪ Review existing organisation structure to identify stakeholders and design governance ▪ Specify approach for testing propositions with customers, plan to establish ▪ Specify required technical and operational testing environments, plan to obtain ▪ Plan inductions and trainings for team ▪ Identify and recruit core team for incubation ▪ Plan Lab logistics
Deliverables	▪ Define scope, ambition and KPIs (operational and financial) ▪ Map of existing customer journeys, value stream ▪ Diagnostic report, e.g. wastage, pain points ▪ Customer profiles ▪ Insights report	▪ Ecosystem map ▪ IT architecture diagram ▪ Stimulus boards (key research and insights) ▪ Insights report	▪ Stakeholder map ▪ Governance structures ▪ Customer engagement / testing plan ▪ Technical and operational testing environments ▪ Location for Lab team ▪ Induction and training plans ▪ Draft list of risks and mitigations

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B. The Incubation phase translates the knowledge gained in the understanding phase to an implementation plan

Key workstreams	B1. Aligning the target strategy with customer vision	B2. Defining the delivery roadmap	B3. Onboarding the team, implementation and evaluation
Activities	▪ Workshops to define target customer experience journeys ▪ Interviews with experts to refine based on Zero Based Design ▪ Working sessions to generate target policies and IT architecture blueprint	▪ Rapid co-creation and ideation by the whole team (incl. product and ops) ▪ Test with experts ▪ Complete deliverable templates ▪ Iterate with stakeholder / experts ▪ Detail “front runner”	▪ Identify full Lab team, defining the hiring plan ▪ Workshops and communication to embed mind-sets required for success ▪ Secure required enablers ▪ Perform risk assessment ▪ Syndicate deliverables with stakeholders ▪ Seek governance approval
Deliverables	▪ Storyboards for customer proposition vision ▪ Target product description ▪ Target customer journey maps ▪ Design briefs ▪ Blueprint of future operational / org design ▪ Target IT architecture ▪ Target policies (incl. conduct/credit risk)	▪ Product roadmap incl. MVP, sub-journeys ▪ IT Development timeline, IT critical path, dependencies ▪ Operational and org trans-formation road-map (incl. KPI) ▪ Business case document ▪ Resource request ▪ List of risks and mitigations	▪ Business case document ▪ Quantitative estimates for baseline and target operational and financial KPIs ▪ Resource request ▪ Core team members onboarded and co- located ▪ Full role and headcount requirements, hiring plan ▪ Location, resources, testing environments available ▪ List of risks and mitigations

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C. The Waves will focus on implementing the solution in an Agile way, test it and roll out to the business

Key workstreams	C1. Implementation and test of the solution	C2. Deployment of the solution in the IT infrastructure	C3. Roll out the solution to the business
Activities	▪ Development of solution (code) ▪ Functional and Non-functional testing ▪ Agile Sprint ceremonies (e.g., backlog grooming)	▪ Detailed definition of required IT Infrastructure and mapping to existing infrastructure ▪ Implementation readiness activities (e.g., governance forums) ▪ Configuration of environments ▪ Build and test of environments ▪ Deployment of working code	▪ Definition plan to roll in the solution ▪ Conduction workshops with business reps ▪ Interlock with senior business stakeholders ▪ Business readiness activities (e.g., Go No-go sessions)
Deliverables	▪ Revised versions of product roadmap incl. MVP, sub-journeys ▪ Feature build plan inc. major dependencies ▪ Test plan ▪ Feedback from user groups and user testing ▪ MVPs/ working software	▪ Detailed IT Development plan, IT critical path, dependencies ▪ Implementation readiness deliverables (e.g., readiness checklist) ▪ List of risks and mitigations	▪ Business industrialisation strategy ▪ Benefits capture plan ▪ Detailed E2E plan ▪ For each segment where the solution is rolled in to: – Detailed roll in delivery plan – Training plan for operations – Business readiness – Transition/Capacity plan (if rolling into existing operation) ▪ Definition of KPIs/MI ▪ List of risks and mitigation

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  - How do our members share expertise across squads?
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There are 10 Journey Teams in TCJ (to be established over time)

TCJ	Programme Oversight & Value Assurance Chapter	Technology Delivery Chapter	Design Chapter	Enablers
Journey Team 1				
Journey Team 2				
Journey Team 10				

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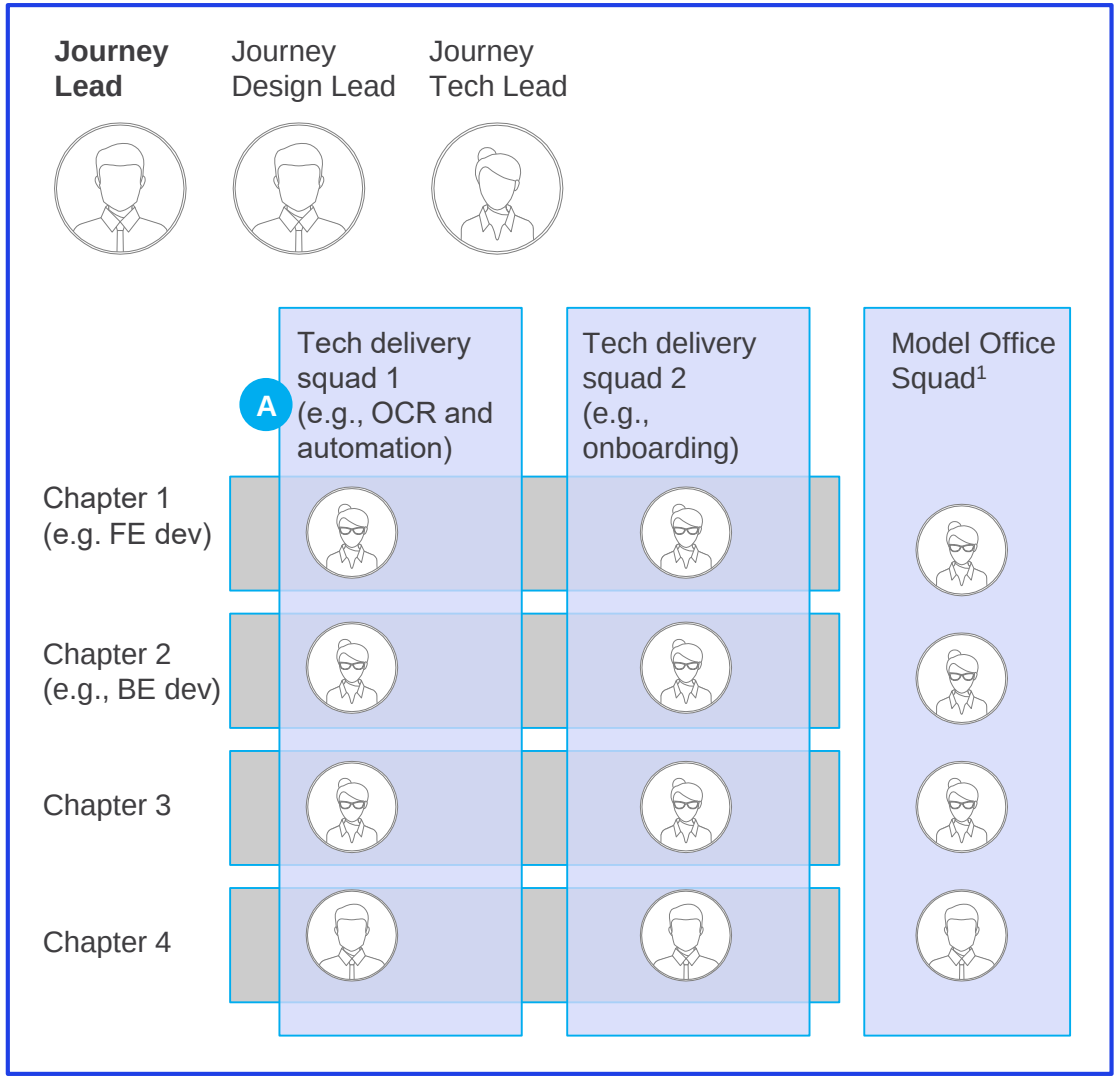
Each Journey Team consists of squad(s)

Decision making body
Accountable person

Journey Team (e.g., Commercial Lending)



Structure

Journey Lab

- Collection of squads organized around CIMB product groups
- No more than 150 people

A Squad[2]

- Has E2E responsibility and autonomy for a certain mission related to the journey
- Multidisciplinary team of ~9 people

Example

10 Customer Journeys

- E.g., Retail CASA, Commercial Lending, Auto Loans, Credit Cards, etc.

Exact squads are defined for each squad depending on wave-by-wave roadmap

- E.g., functionality, sub-journey

1 Detailed further in separate playbook
2 There is no fixed organizational structure for Journey Lab. E.g. a squad can be set up for data cleaning for one Wave and dismantled during the next Wave.
SOURCE: Interviews with experts from other digital factories

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Each Journey Team member is assigned to a squad

Bold – Coordinator roles

TCJ

Journey Team 1

- **Journey Lead**
- **Master Journey Design Lead[1]**
- **Master Journey Tech Lead[1]**

- Navigator
- Business Analyst

- IT industrialization SME

Squad 1

- Product owner
- Scrum master
- Journey Tech Lead
- Solution Architect
- Dev Ops Engineer
- FE and BE developer(s)
- Tester / QA (s)
- Journey Design Lead
- Visual designer
- UX designer

Squad 2

- Product owner
- Scrum master
- Journey Tech Lead
- Solution Architect
- Dev Ops Engineer
- FE and BE developer(s)
- Tester / QA (s)
- Journey Design Lead
- Visual designer
- UX designer

Model office squad

- MO Lead
- SMEs

Journey Team N

Enablers

1 Role could be played by an additional member or by a Squad member that “double-hats” / takes on additional responsibility

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The squads are set up based on each Journey Team's delivery plan

Example set up for Commercial Lending Journey Team (preliminary view)

	Incubation *(2 months)*	Wave 1 *(3 months)*	Wave 2 *(3 months)*	Wave 3 *(3 months)*	Wave 4 *(3 months)*
OCR & Automation squad	Diagnosis of LOS workflow & data-entry and solution definition	**Automation and Workflow stream-lining** to enhance efficiency of data entry to create a credit application	**Enhancements**		
Onboarding squad	Ideation, design and wireframing		**Front-end interface:** to support RMs in managing leads and customer interactions		
Facility Renewal squad				**Capability** to provide fast-track renewals with minimal documentation	
Credit Complete onboarding squad				**Front-end interface:** to support RMs in having conversations with customer	
Disbursement squad					**Automation and workflow streamlining:** to enhance efficiency of iCIMB processes
Pre-approval squad					**Capability** to provide pre-approved loan offers for good ETB customers

- Squad blueprint (number of squads, mission of each squad, composition in each squad) will evolve over each Wave.
- The plan may also evolve as additional learnings emerge from incubation and previous waves.
- Squad blueprint will also depend on IT resourcing

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How each squad is set up

Delivery empowerment at squad level
Management responsible for defining business objectives and benefit targets (the “what”) and squad for realizing it (the “how”). The team has authority to make all decisions necessary to deliver the required objective

Minimum handovers
Targets are designed to be delivered by one squad

Entire lifecycle focus
Squad responsibilities cover development and maintenance, across business and IT

Deliverables every 12 weeks
Incremental delivery process results in squads realizing target every super sprint (i.e. three months)

Customer value focus
All squad targets result in deliverables that directly create customer value

Minimal organisational layers
Full managerial positions limited to executive management and tribe leads

Cross-functional squad
Squad includes all skills needed to go from product backlog to production-ready solution

Co-located squads
All squad members are co-located and work side-by-side at a single site. Journey Teams can and will span locations.

Maximum squad size of 9
No more than nine people in one squad

Servant-leader roles
Everyone is primarily a squad member. PO/ CL roles are contributors to squad deliverables

All work conducted by squads
All work is carried out at squad level with rare expertise sourced from CoEs when needed

Full time dedication
Squad members dedicate 100% of their time to role and tasks in order to reach squad target

Self-organizing
The team decides how to best to organize themselves to meet the team’s goals

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Key members in the Journey Team: Journey Lead

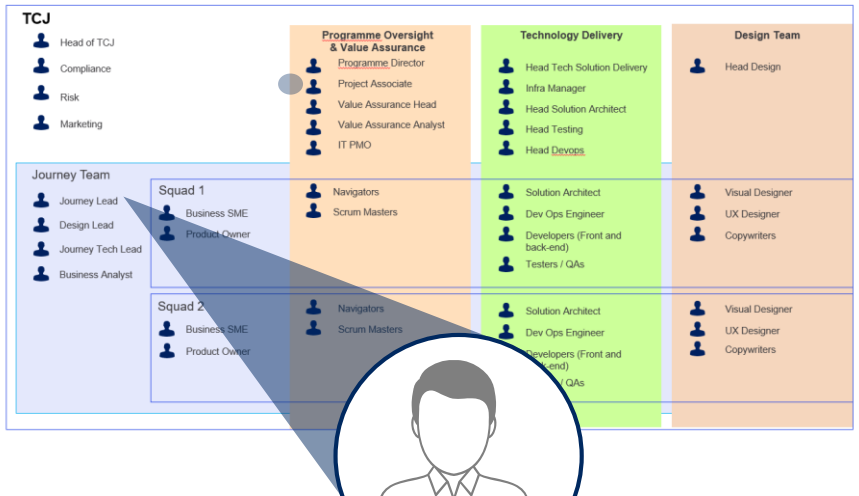
Broad description

Responsible for managing a Journey and achieving the Journey Lab's business goals. Responsible for the Journey Lab's key performance indicators depending on its tasks (such as P&L, NPS, market share, systems availability (uptime, number of incidents), etc.)

Workload

- A dedicated, **100% full-time** role on the squad

Journey Lab structure



JOURNEY LEAD

Main duties and powers

Managing the product / process

- Define **vision** for products and services and present it to the Journey Team, **make product lifecycle decisions (building, scaling, etc.)**
- Define and enforce **quality standards** (non-functional requirements)
- Validate implementation solutions, define product **acceptance criteria**
- **Accept** significant deliverables
- **Effectively coordinate with key stakeholders** to resolve business design and delivery issues

Planning and prioritizing the work

- **Shape the Journey Team backlog:** define and prioritize **epics** for the Journey Team
- **Synchronize** the vision with Product Owners in **Squads,** Lead the formulation of the Journey Team and Squads mission and goals
- **Prepare Quarterly Business Review (QBR) report** for Journey Team
- Design and maintain the overll roadmap
- Manage **expectations** of all stakeholders, especially CXOs and TL peers

Contributing to personnel management and development

- Make proposals on the Journey Team's **composition and headcount** for each delivery Wave
- Manage the **Journey Team budget**

Artifacts in the area of responsibility

- Journey Team wave-by-wave roadmap (incl. what products to deliver each Wave, description of products, what squads to set up)
- **Journey Team Wave backlog**
- QBR (Quarterly Business Review)

Must not

- Make decisions about execution methods
- Build a hierarchy within the Journey Team
- Micromanage, impose instructions on Squads
- Penalize Journey Team members

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Key members in the Journey Team: Product Owner

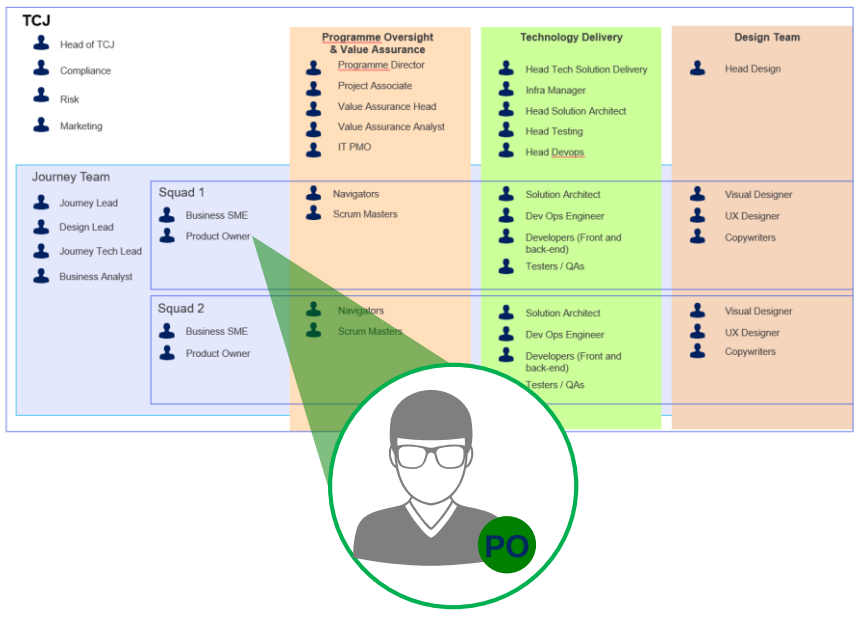
Broad description

Responsible for **releasing a product** that meets the **customer's needs** to achieve the **tribe's goals. Defines and prioritizes requirements in the Squad Backlog** and also accepts **requirements** as completed. Central Product Owners are Product Owners within one squad with coordinating responsibility across Squads. They are NOT the direct superiors of other Product Owners

Workload

- A dedicated, **100% full-time** role on the squad

Journey Lab structure



PRODUCT OWNER

Main duties and powers

Managing the product

- **Develop product vision and synchronize it** with the Journey Team Lead and Product Owners in Squads responsible for related products
- **Define product requirements;** make sure they are complete, integral and consistent; the **sole source of requirements** for the Squad
- Scope the MVP, taking into account existing resource constraints and sustained development of the product
- **Accept** sprint results at demonstration
- Contribute to Squad product development to the extent of her or his competence

Setting targets and work priorities

- **Build Squad backlog** in terms of user stories, **prioritize** its items to achieve business goals, continuously keep the backlog up to date
- Hold meetings with the Squad to update the Squad's product backlog
- Make sure the Squad **correctly understands** the requirements
- Participate in **planning** of the Squad's sprint, **planning of the Journey Team's Wave** to reaffirm priorities and clarify the requirements
- **Interact with other Squads** of one's own and other tribes as part of **Squad synchronization** ceremonies to implement cross-Squad tasks

Participating in Squad development

- Together with the Journey Team and Chapter Lead, define the set of necessary competences in the Squad
- Participate in Squad performance review

Artifacts in the area of responsibility

- Squad backlog
- Product roadmap to be delivered by the squad (incl. vision and description)
- Sprint backlog (in terms of relevance of priorities and clarity of requirements)
- Definitions of Done

Must not

- Micromanage, impose instructions on the Squad
- Play "boss" to the Squad, make prescriptive decisions about execution methods
- Build a hierarchy within the Squad

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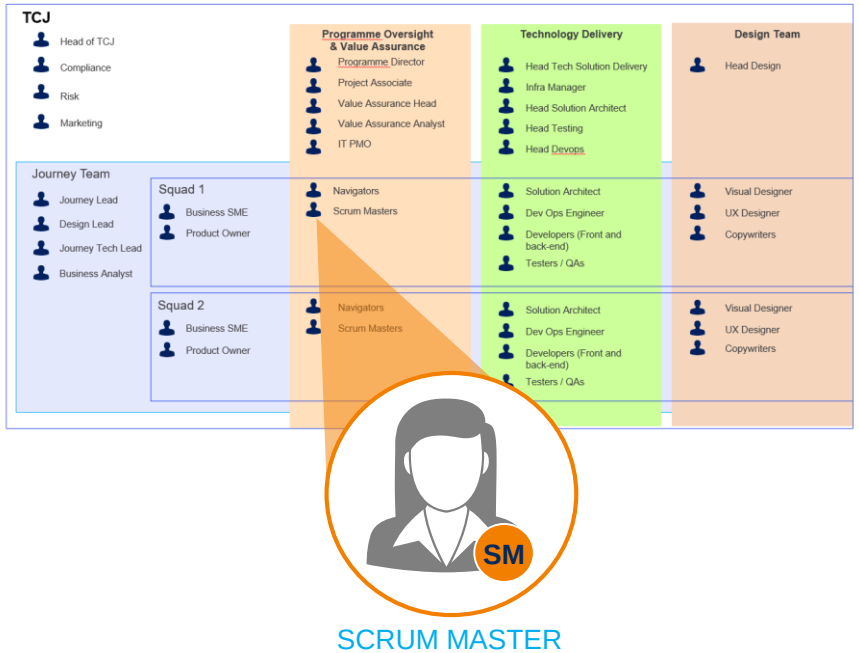
Key members in the Journey Team: Journey Tech Lead

Broad description

The Tech Lead owns the architectural decisions for the Squad. The TL is an executor and the visionary force behind the technical solution. The TL works closely with all team members to create a modular, scalable solution that addresses/incorporates future architectural changes and designs. The TL will drive the teams engineering practices in test driven development, continuous integration, and automated deployment.

Journey Lab structure



SCRUM MASTER

Workload

- A dedicated, **100% full-time** role on the squad
- Spends most of the time working hand in hand with the squads in squad area

Main duties and powers

Creating solutions

- Shares responsibility with Product Owner for building reusable and scalable components
- **Participate in planning, definition and high-level design of a solution; explore architectural alternatives,** aid Squads in identifying technologies and making architectural decisions
- **Synchronize architectural solution among Squads** and resolve architectural differences and dependencies within the Journey Team
- Define **critical non-functional requirements** for the solution
- Manage interdependencies with architectural solutions of other Journey Teams

Designing and enforcing architectural standards

- Design **the Journey Team's target architecture and maintain technical roadmap**
- Make sure Journey Team architecture conforms to the Journey Team's architectural standards and target architecture
- Design **architectural standards together with architects outside the tribe**
- Decide whether to pilot new technology solutions in the Journey Team and make proposals to roll out successful solutions (coordinating with architects outside tribe)
- Make sure service architecture conforms to the Journey Team/Cluster target architecture
- Manage temporary solutions and technical debt at the Journey Team/Cluster level

Release planning

- Determine the **necessary technology competencies** for Squads together with the Journey Team Lead
- Participate in **release preparation and planning** to determine the necessary architectural improvements according to the architecture roadmap and current priorities in the Journey Team backlog

Artifacts in the area of responsibility

- Journey Team roadmap
- Conceptual architecture of the product / function area

Must not

- Design detailed architectural solutions at the start
- Evade decision-making
- Reject proposed solutions without offering alternatives

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Key members in the Journey Team: Scrum master

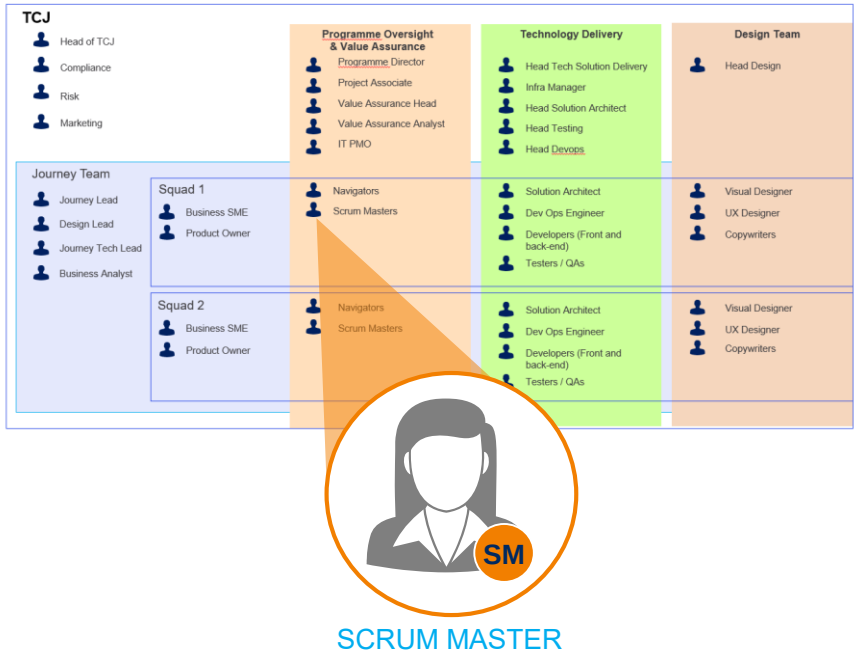
Broad description

A Squad member and servant-leader responsible for workflow efficiency, the Squad's understanding of Agile development practices, building effective interfaces with other Squads and units, and promoting self-organization and maturity of the Squad.

Workload

- A dedicated, **100% full-time** role on the squad
- Spends most of the time working hand in hand with the squads in squad area

Journey Lab structure



SCRUM MASTER

Main duties and powers

Managing the product

- **Facilitate Squad ceremonies** from sprint planning to demonstration
- **Track progress** and achievement of the Squad goals at daily stand-ups using burndown charts/cumulative flow diagrams
- **Coordinate interaction with other Squads** of one's own and other tribes (e.g. during Quarterly Journey Team Review planning or other tribe Squads synchronization ceremonies)
- **Manage the processes of decomposition and task estimation, finding dependencies** with other Squads and updating the backlog to prepare the Squad for QTR
- **Administer the backlog** in the production system
- Help other Squads and conventional parts of the organization build **effective communication** and interaction with the Squad

Setting targets and work priorities

- **Ensure compliance and continuous improvement of Agile ceremonies** and practices, teaching new techniques to the Squad as needed
- **Create and maintain an atmosphere of trust** through facilitation of retrospectives and feedback exchange among Squad members
- **Clear obstacles in the Squad's path** (such as dependencies on other Squads), maintain a list of obstacles
- Contribute to Squad product development to the extent of her or his competence

Artifacts in the area of responsibility

- Definitions of Done
- Lessons learned from retrospective
- Sprint backlog (the effective planning ceremony part)

Must not

- Assign people to tasks
- Act like the Squad's boss, make prescriptive decisions about execution methods
- Build a hierarchy within the Squad

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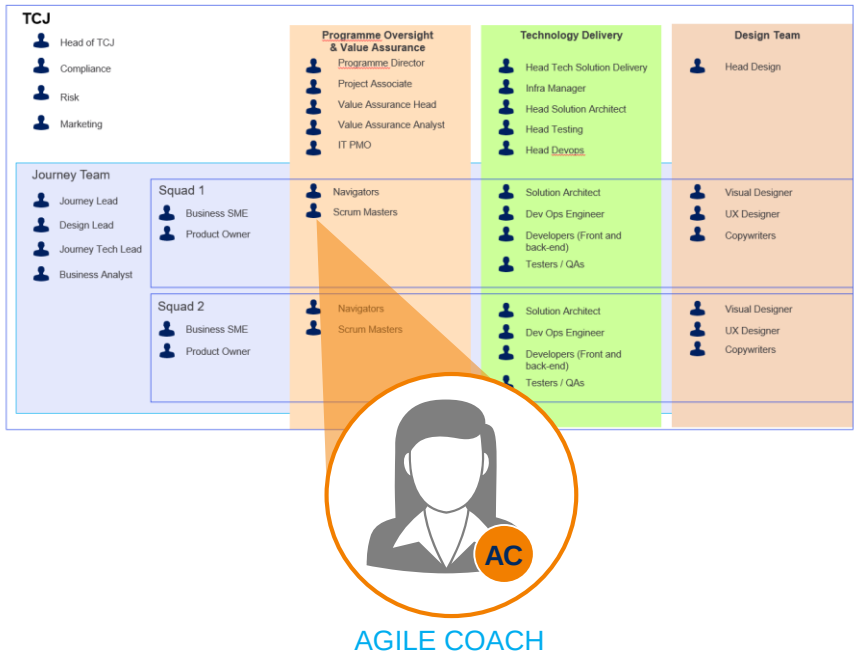
Key members in the Journey Team: Agile coach

Broad description

Process facilitator and coach. The guardian of agile mindset and processes. AC is responsible for managing squad releases, synchronization, efficiency of squad processes and keeping up continuous improvement. The AC develops a deep understanding of the tribes and squads processes and adds value with broader perspective. One AC guides each 3-5 squads

Journey Lab structure



AGILE COACH

Workload

- A dedicated, **100% full-time** role on the squad
- Spends most of the time working hand in hand with the squads in squad area

Main duties and powers

Introducing the Agile approach

- Synchronize various squads activities and release process and manage **risk and relationships** among Squads within scope
- **Launch** the Squad, **set up result delivery processes**
- Work on **continuous development and improvement of methods** (together with other Agile Coaches) and incorporate them into day-to-day work of the Squads
- **Develop procedures for sharing knowledge** and expertise within the tribe
- Leads meetings initially and then transfers to team member to ensure full team engagement

Building highly effective squads

- Sets up and conducts the ceremonies **on squad level** (prepares plans, proposals, backlogs by aggregating and analyzing information from POs, **demos and retros**)
- Participates all ceremonies for squads in charge and supports/ facilitates process.
- Supports coordination and synchronizes between squads where needed
- Sets up and facilitates Journey Team **demonstrations and retrospectives**
- **Keeps an objective perspective on issues and troubleshoots by applying agile principles**

Ensuring continuous improvement

- Promote **self-organization and team spirit** inside the Squad and Journey Team, promotes **continuous improvement,** pushes for the right, not the easy solution
- **Identify issues** and successes of Squads.
- **Assess** Squad members and communicate improvement opportunities **(POCLAC),** hold 1:1 conversations with squad members

Artifacts in the area of responsibility

- Maintain overview on squad backlog (with PO)
- Squad and tribe retrospective lessons
- Individual evaluation of team members in POCLAC (Product Owner – Chapter Lead – Agile Coach committee)

Must not

- Assign people to tasks (instead, each Squad member self-assigns tasks together during sprint planning)
- Act like the Squad's boss, make prescriptive decisions about execution methods
- Build a hierarchy within the Squad or tribe
- Lose focus on top priority: To guide the squads to success

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Subject Matter Expert (Journey expert) role card

ROLE CARDS TO BE REFINED CONTINUOUSLY

Broad description

- Is a squad member responsible for the new customer journey (often called Journey Expert). The journey expert will take lead in understanding the existing process, detailing out user stories and acceptance criteria, gathering customer input and identifying a smooth transition to the new journey

Workload

- A dedicated role taking up to **100% of the time**

Typical skills, and background

- Preferably several years of experience within the business and/or industry
- Background could be in e.g. Sales, Marketing, Customer Service, and/or Operations depending on the needs of the squad
- Knowledgeable about internal business processes
- Expert on customer needs and pain points
- Operational mindset and track record of delivering value hands-on
- Sense of ownership – autonomously driving initiatives and improvements without needing close management

Main duties and powers

Understand existing process

- **Has a strong understanding of the existing process**, including key pain points, legal requirements and/or systems involved
- **Answer questions and have views** on topics within their expertise
- **Help in calculations and information gathering** for tactical/strategic decisions (e.g. calculating value of implementing features, performing pro/con or quantitative analysis)

Operationally help define user stories

- Take a **leading role in thinking of user story ideas** (e.g. based on area of expertise – sales, service, legal, etc.)
- Discuss with PO, UX and developers **to clarify details around user stories** that are already in backlog (both own ideas and others')
- **Write/document user story** definitions and acceptance criteria

Validate with customers

- **Organize and conduct customer tests** with customers to validate assumptions or questions, and test the new journey
- Decide on most appropriate testing approach and is responsible for all required preparations (e.g. questionnaire, interview script)

Test final solution

- **Test new journey throughout the various stages of development**, based on pre-defined test scenarios and test data
- **Identify exception cases and validates** whether they are correctly handled by the new solution

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Developer role card

Broad description

- Develop software functionality in e.g. HTML, CSS, React, java and participate actively in the squad, by taking a leading role in discussions and ceremonies, to help shape implementable user stories

Workload

- A dedicated role taking up to **100% of the time**

Typical skills, and background

- 5 -10 years of software development experience, with knowledge of Agile software development process
- Excellent understanding of latest development technologies
- Infrastructure knowledge
- Background in architecture and protocols to connect to industrial machines
- Experiences with code refactoring, design patterns, design-driven development, continuous deployment, highly scalable applications, and application security
- Expert in pair programming, continuous integration, test-driven development & incremental design
- Experience with big data, relational and NoSQL data stores

Main duties and powers

Agile software development

- **Use agile engineering practices** and various software and web development technologies to rapidly develop creative and efficient solutions that enhance the client customer and employee experience
- Collaborate with other agile team members to **craft clear user stories**, design tests for prototypes and products, and continuously deliver product enhancements

Communica-tion and participation

- Align and integrate well with **architects, designers and other stakeholders**
- **Communicate with other developers** across squads, both as ad hoc problem solvings, and in Chapter check-ins and discussions
- **Support non-technical team members in understanding** the technical implications of design decisions

Business alignment

- **Communicate with business stakeholders** about agile processes to set and manage expectations about delivery methods and timelines
- Continuously reach out to **demonstrate and validate developed functionality**

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Designer role card

Broad description

- Drive user experience design from end-to-end, including ideation, concept development, detailed design, prototypes and user testing and work together with Product Owners and developers to create great customer journeys that deliver business impact

Workload

- A dedicated role taking up to **100% of the time**

Typical skills, and background

- Experience in software design and development with knowledge of the Agile way of working
- Bachelor's degree in Design or equivalent area
- Experience with designing quality products or experiences, as well as enabling business objectives through technology
- Well-rounded user-centered design portfolio spanning e.g. web, mobile, tablet, and potentially consumer products or media
- Graphical and Visual design skills, including use of a diverse set of software such as Adobe suite, OmniGraffle, Balsamiq, Azure, or other tools
- Experience with conducting user research, usability testing, A/B testing, rapid prototyping

Main duties and powers

Create customer journeys

- **Ideate and articulate concepts** for new customer journeys or improvements to existing ones
- **Produce and review wireframes** and story boards for digital products
- **Define the visual style** and position of a service based on design guidelines, and create implementable screenshots or mocks

Customer involvement

- Research, identify and **articulate customer needs**
- **Build prototypes and design tests** to validate customer needs, requirements and behaviors
- **Design, deliver and test** intuitive customer experiences as part of a cross-functional agile product teams

Vision development

- Help Product Owner define **both long and short-term vision and roadmap** for digital products at client digital unit
- Collaborate with other designers within and cross-team to problem solve design challenges and maintain a level of **design consistency and coherence across products and services**

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Tester role card

Broad description

- Testing and validating the quality of the software output and owning the test and quality assurance processes towards external stakeholders where applicable (e.g. for Main Releases)

Workload

- The tester **role can be shared by the delivery squad**, but a common practice is to have a dedicated tester working **30-50%** with the squad

Typical skills, and background

- Several years of experience within software development and knowledge of an Agile software development process
- Good understanding of the E2E system landscape
- Infrastructure knowledge
- Experience with writing and automating test cases
- Knowledgeable of business processes and customer needs
- Ownership mindset – track-record of getting things fixed not simply discovered
- Preferably a feeling for good design and grammar

Main duties and powers

Drive the testing effort in the squad

- Write and help others **write test cases**
- **Perform acceptance test of user stories** on a day-to-day basis
- **Perform end-to-end** tests in relation to larger releases with external stakeholders

Own the testing process

- **Drive the squad's test strategy** and test efforts, e.g. taking initiative to automate where possible and coaching others
- **Own the process during test periods** where functionality is tested across several squads and departments

Participate in creating quality user stories

- Be an **active participant in grooming and planning**, to ensure that acceptance criteria are testable
- Sit together with designers, SMEs and Product Owner while user stories are developed, **bringing input and helping with the testing angle**

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Other Journey Team / Tech Delivery squad members

1	**Business Analyst**	▪ Responsible for conducting operational capacity planning and risk assessments ▪ Write test cases for business requirements by creating test coverage matrices ▪ Modify business requirements to make the process leaner
2	**Navigator (s) ***	▪ Support Value Assurance Head on financial analysis, definition, tracking of TCJ program economics and validation ▪ Influence and collaborate with cross discipline teams
3	**Visual designer (s) ***	▪ Responsible for creating mock-ups and wireframes for both mobile and web pages ▪ Work with front-end and full-stack developers in multi-disciplinary teams to implement designs ▪ Conduct user experience research and testing through media such as A/B testing, interviews, etc.
4	**UX designer (s) ***	▪ Lead user research, design strategy, information architecture and interaction design ▪ Contribute to produce user requirements specifications, personas refinement, storyboarding, and scenario, or customer journey creation and visualization ▪ Work with visual designers and software engineering teams to ensure design specifications are implemented correctly, participating in bug tracking/fixing and QA
5	**Journey Tech Lead (s)**	▪ Lead application developer ▪ Work with solution architect to shape technical end-state for a particular Journey Team ▪ Coach developers
6	**Tester / QA (s) ***	▪ Review implementation and efficiency of quality and inspection systems ▪ Plan, conduct and monitor testing and inspection of materials and products to ensure finished product quality ▪ Analyze data to identify areas for improvement in the quality system

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Journey Team / Tech Delivery squad members

7	**Front-end developers**	▪ Provide production support that includes evaluate efforts, investigate cause and come up with solutions to address defects ▪ Write documentation specific to developed APIs and component implementations ▪ Participate in discussions with user teams and agile team members about technical best practices
8	**Full-stack developers**	▪ Full stack development, collaborating with other developers and designers on the various layers of the infrastructure for our digital solutions ▪ Contribute to the design and architecture to enable secure, scalable, and maintainable software and should be able to clearly articulate the implications of design/architectural decisions, issues and plans to technology leadership ▪ Develop reusable patterns and encourage innovation that will enhance team velocity
9	**API / back-end developers**	▪ Work closely with end-users to identify issues and capture business requirements ▪ Integrate user-facing elements developed by front-end developer with service side logic ▪ Design and implement data storage solutions
10	**Solution architect**	▪ Collaborate with product owner and project control office to plan, build, launch, and implement the technical aspects of products ▪ Work with the product owners to oversee overall the design and implementation ▪ Lead DevOps team to ensure collaboration between the Digital team and the key business users
11	**DevOps Engineer**	▪ Partner with Tech Leads and developers of various teams to assess existing problems and provide solutions ▪ Identify bottlenecks in coding development and deployment processes ▪ Survey developers and technical members of the organization to understand their main pain points in the coding and development process

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What are cross-journey elements that we need to put in place to enable the journeys to run smoothly?

- Overview: Role of each Journey Team undergoes
- **Journey Team Org Blueprint**
  - How are we organized?
  - Who are our squad members?
  - **How do our members share expertise across squads?**
- Journey Team agile way of working
- Journey Team ceremonies / cadence

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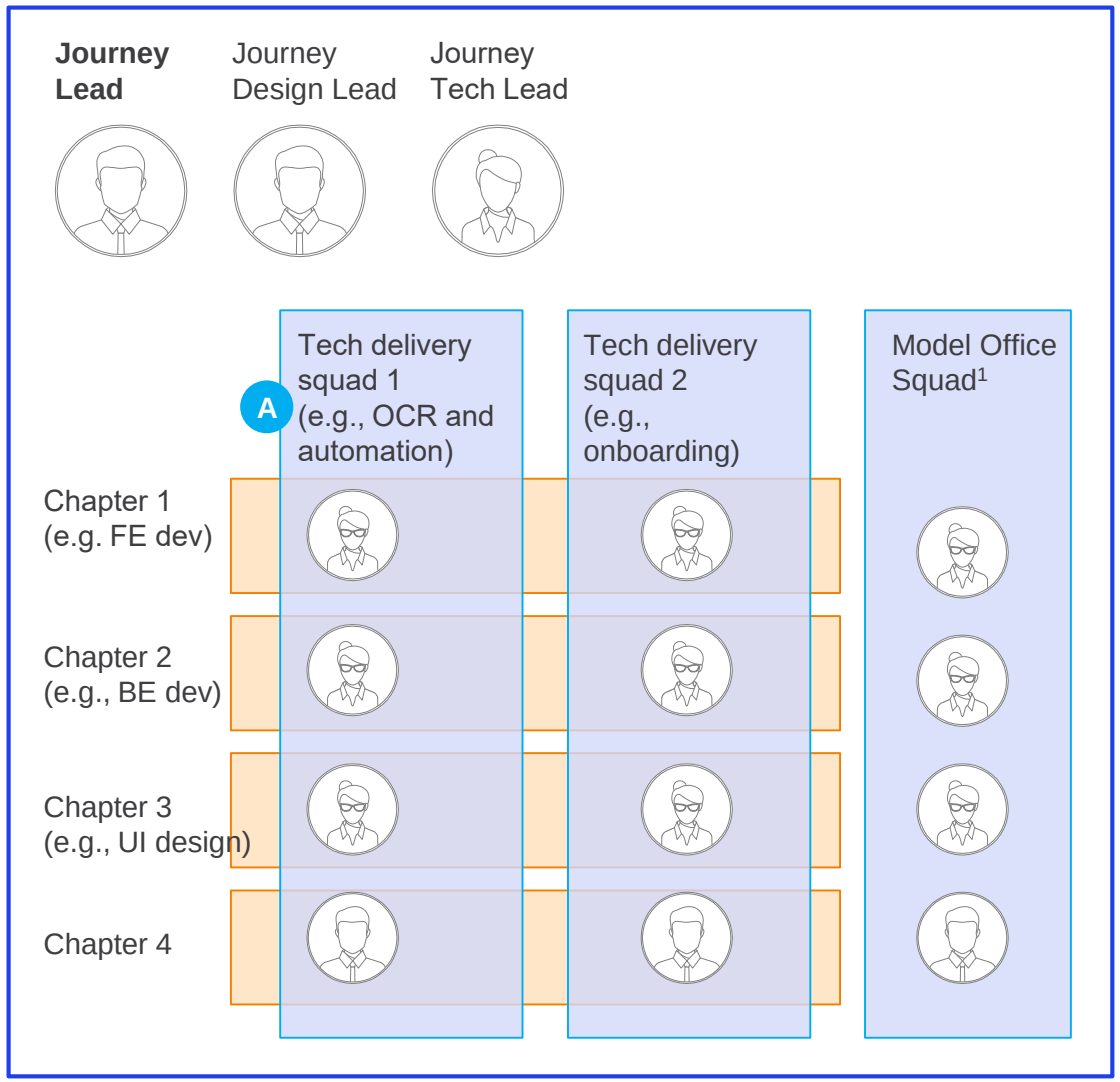
In agile, chapters are a **group of specialists for one competency area**

Journey Team (e.g., Commercial Lending)



Hallmarks of Chapters

Responsible for:
- Building expertise,
- Maintaining a common approach to similar tasks, and
- People development

All Squad members belong to one chapter / competence center

Personnel responsibility and people development lies on chapter lead

One person can't be both PO and Chapter Lead (i.e., no mix of business and people responsibility)

Chapters are kept "broad" to enable competence sharing

Typically 5-10 people in size to ensure manageability

Not a decision-making role

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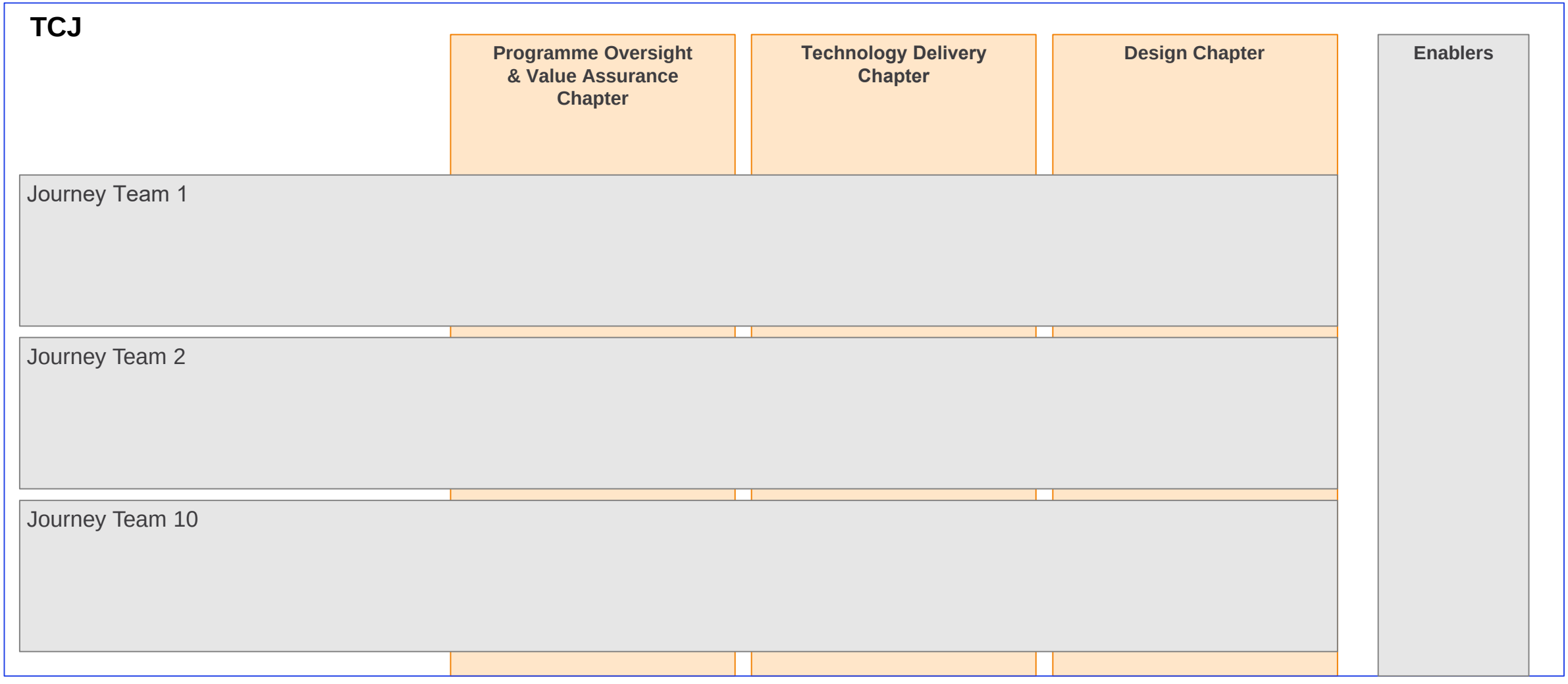
There are three main chapters in TCJ



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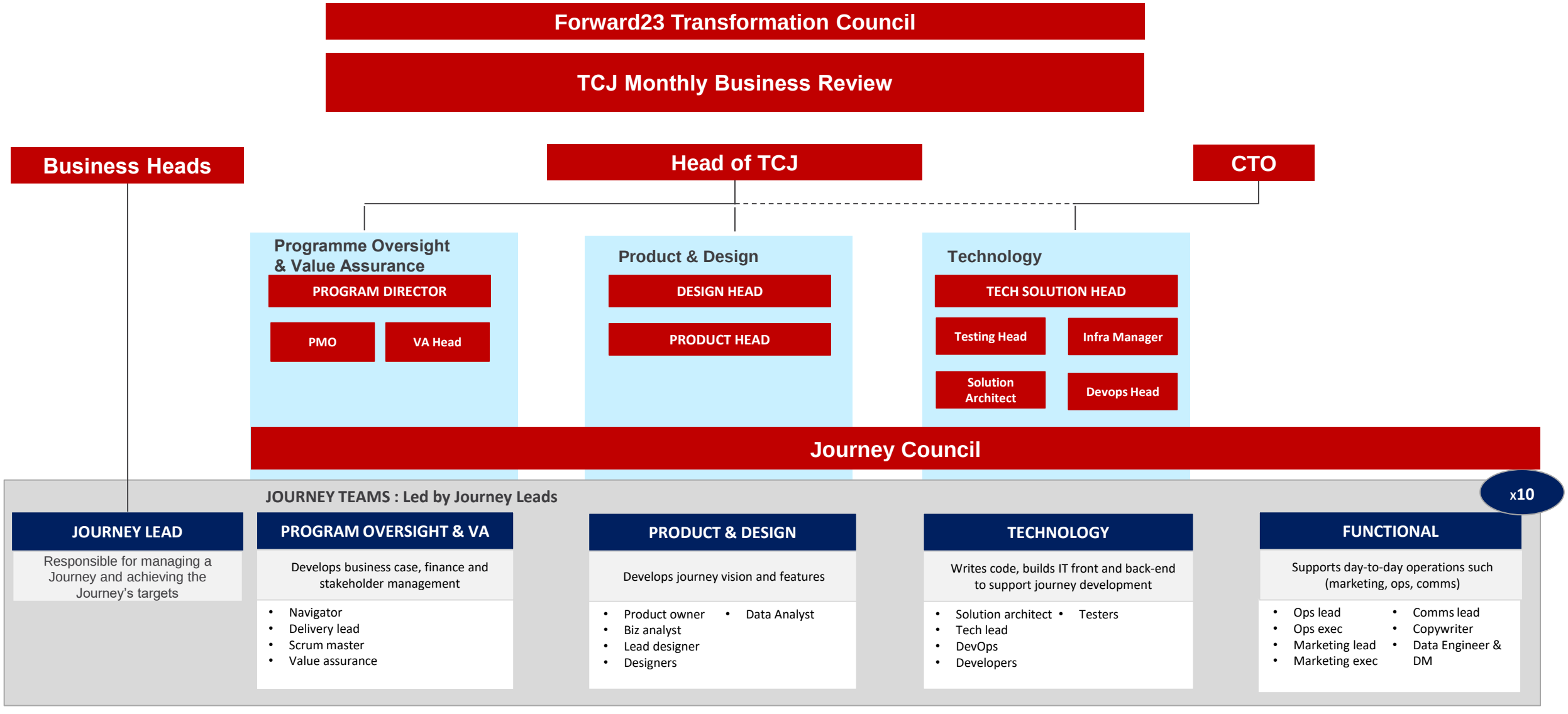
Digital factory is being set up to deliver impact with the TCJ program



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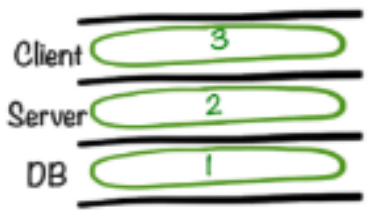
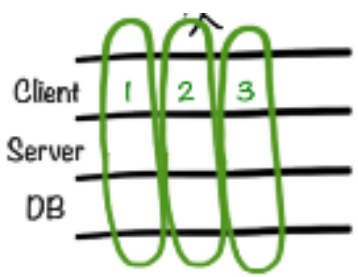
At the heart of agile way of working is iterative and incremental development

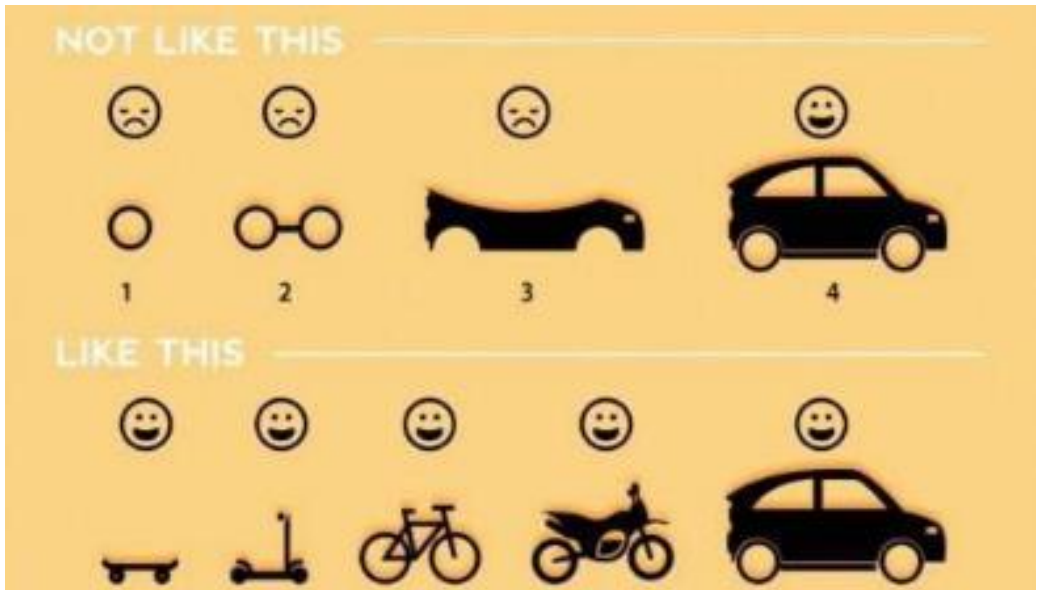
- **Iteratively ->** don't build all at once
- **Incrementally ->** don't try and get it all correct from the start

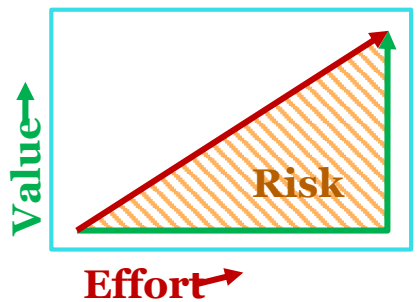
Not horizontal increments…

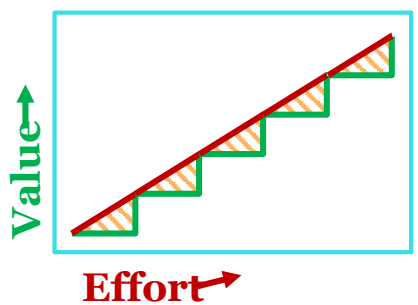


…but vertical increments









If the customer wants to travel from A- B, which of the 2 approaches adds value sooner?

- Reduce risk and increase learning by building iteratively and incrementally
- Agile is; "*the early delivery of business value*" – Allister Cockburn

SOURCE: Allister Cockburn and Henrik Kniberg

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Each Journey Team will adopt a set of practices that target fast delivery of high-quality results in a collaborative environment

Collaboration in co-located flat E2E cross-functional / autonomous squads

Time-boxed sprints
with fixed scope, timeline and deliverables

Prioritization of only what really matters and needs to be done (e.g. creating the “Minimum Viable Products”)

Visualizing flow of work of work on e.g. Kanban/Scrum boards and limiting work in progress

Lightweight ceremonies for alignment within and between squads instead of lengthy committees

Customer involvement, where customers and users engaged throughout design and testing

Continuous integration & testing
- Functions are integrated as they are completed into an up-to-date and clean codebase
- Daily or more frequent build process with automated regression testing

Short iterations
to enable tight feedback loop, frequent delivery of working software, and strong focus

Acceleration of tech delivery
- Granular management of activities and progress on a daily basis with agile project management tools facilitate distributed teams and Agile-specific metric reports (e.g., Rally)
- Working software is preferred over documentation and is the main measure of progress
- Extensive use of modern development tools, testing, integration, and project management

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TCJ agile teams use Scrum framework to structure and manage their work

1

Product Backlog

- User focused prioritized product features

2

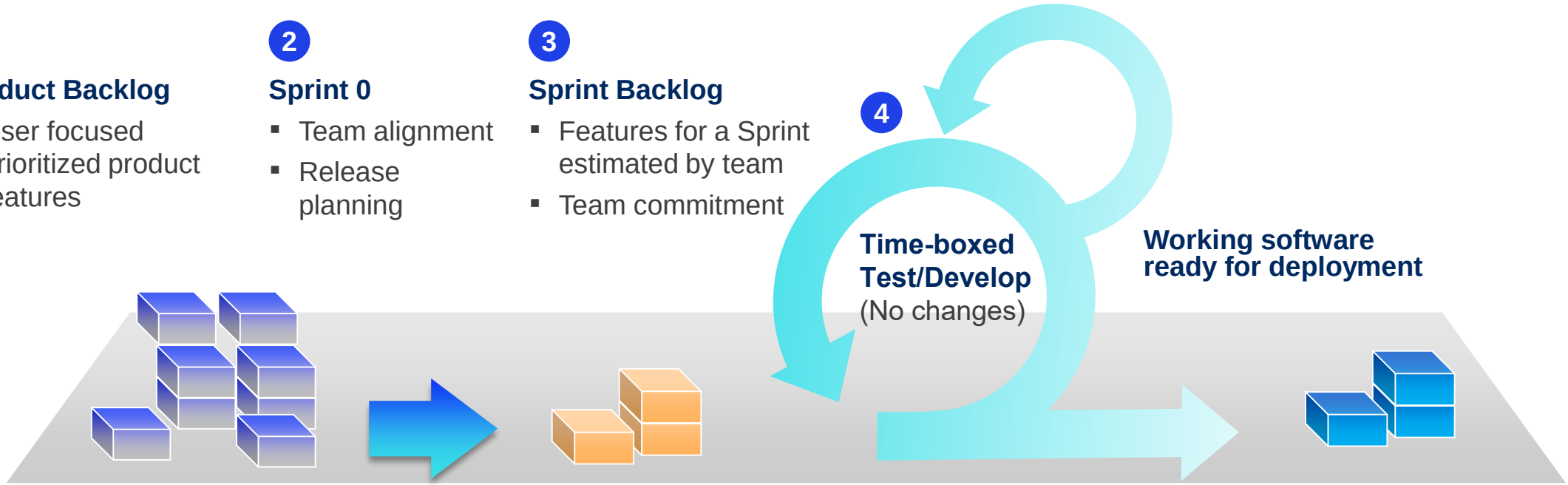
Sprint 0

- Team alignment
- Release planning

3

Sprint Backlog

- Features for a Sprint estimated by team
- Team commitment



- Scrum allows teams of people to develop complex products in an environment of **uncertainty and change**
- It is a simple but powerful framework for teams and customers to **inspect and adapt** as product is produced
- It provides a high degree of **clarity and transparency** to everyone involved: team, clients, users, stakeholders
- It also rapidly surfaces dysfunction and enables teams and organizations to **continuously improve** their effectiveness

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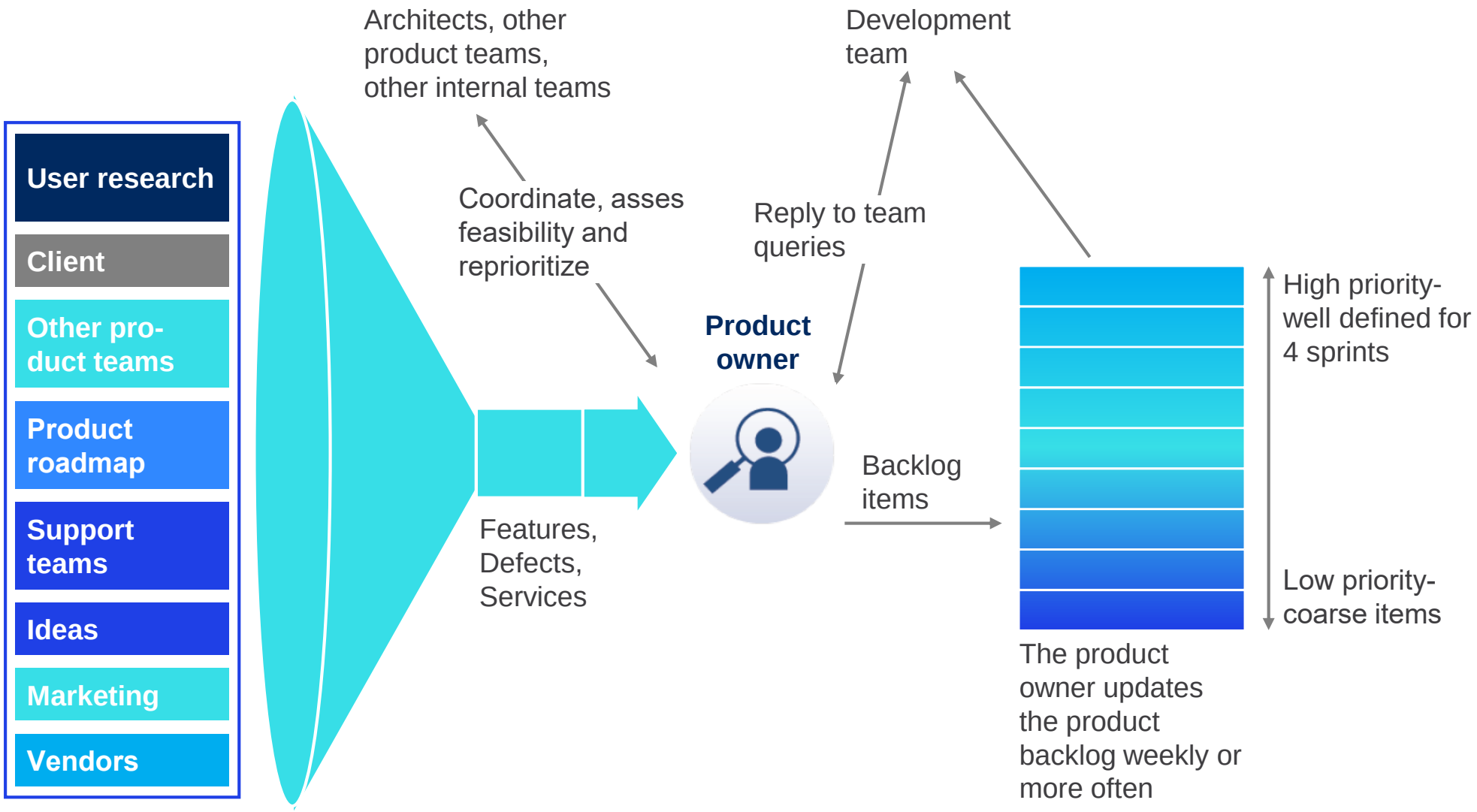
1 The Product Owner creates and manages the backlog with input from multiple sources and synthesizes it into a prioritized single list



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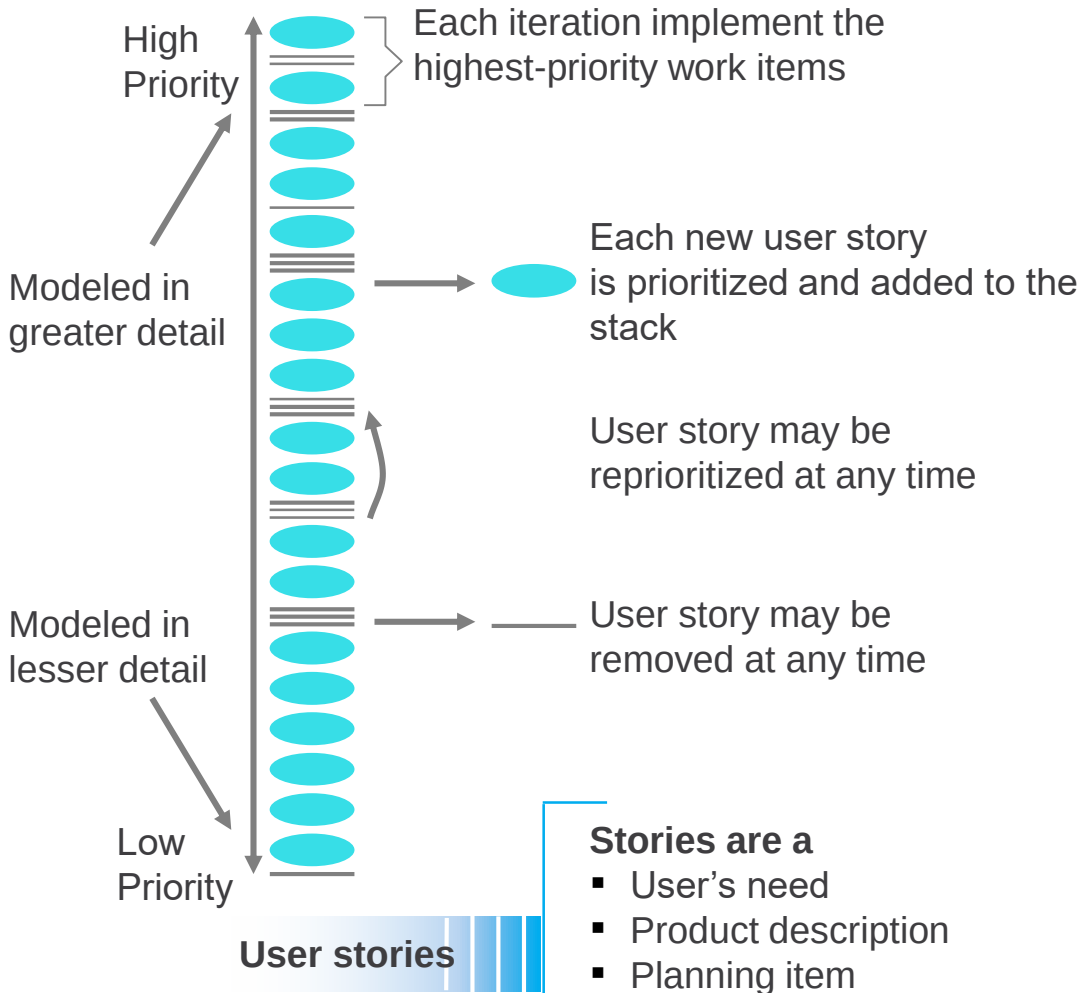
1 The Product Backlog is a collection of work to be done (stories) arranged in order of business priority and technical complexity



Stories are a

- User's need
- Product description
- Planning item
- Token for a conversation
- Mechanism for deferring conversation

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2 Sprint 0 is pre-requisite to a team starting to sprint and focuses on 4 key areas to put in place the building blocks

	1	2	3	4
	Mobilize team	**Product vision**	**Technology**	**Process**
Objectives	▪ Team alignment on working role and responsibility ▪ Ramp up on project context ▪ Team norms, working agreements and cadence	▪ Alignment of business vision and goals ▪ Define solution storyline and success criteria	▪ Understand dependencies and key areas that will be touched ▪ Architecture design to support desired functionality	▪ Release planning, and deliverables ▪ Understand constraints and impediments ▪ Define sprint cadence
Deliver-ables	▪ Role definition and accountability ▪ Working agreements ▪ Feedback preference	▪ Prioritized release backlog to deliver proposed user experience ▪ Initial wireframes	▪ High level impact analysis ▪ Architecture diagrams ▪ Environment setups ▪ Technical POCs	▪ Definition of Done ▪ Ready for Work ▪ Velocity estimation ▪ Release workplan in backlog mgmt tool ▪ Sprint length and cadence defined
Timing	**Day 1**	**Day 2**	**Day 3**	**Day 4-5**

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2 The team establishes a shared understanding of what it means to be ‘done”

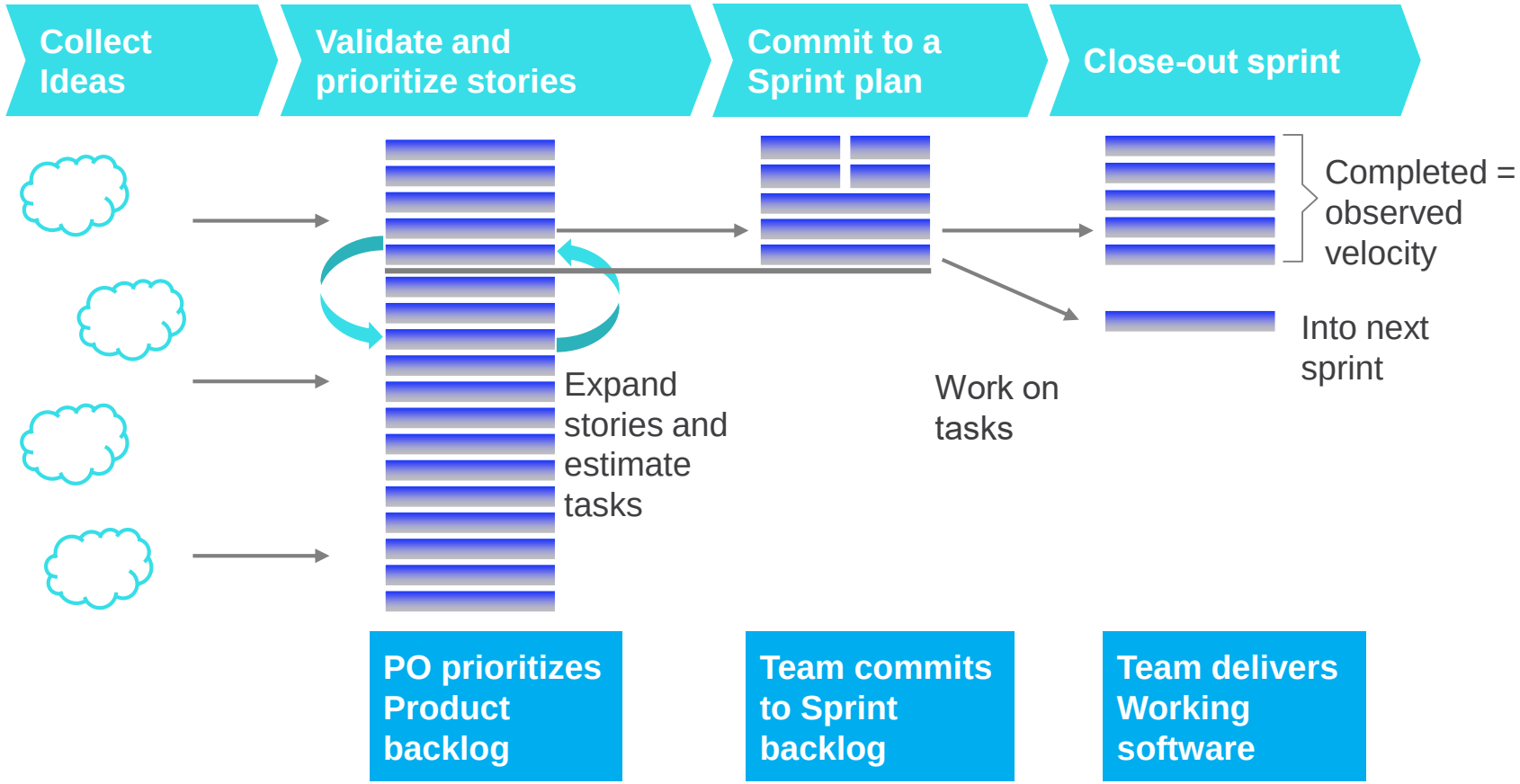
Uniquely established by each team but objective is to align on the criteria to deliver a shippable product after each iteration

Teams typically start with a simple definition of done and slowly evolves as they have a stable sustained velocity

- Unit tests automated and passing
- Unit test cases written
- Meets all acceptance criteria
- Performance tests automated & passing
- Deployed in Integration env.
- Code reviewed & refactored
- Functional tests automated & passing
- Checked in
- Accepted by PO

The **definition of done** ensure that the working software produced at the end of the sprint is of high quality and potentially shippable

3 A sprint is a fixed period of time typically between 1-4 weeks



- Sprints occur one after another, without any down-time between them. Working at a **sustainable pace** is very important to avoid team burn-out
- Team decides the sprint length in advance and it stays consistent sprint to sprint

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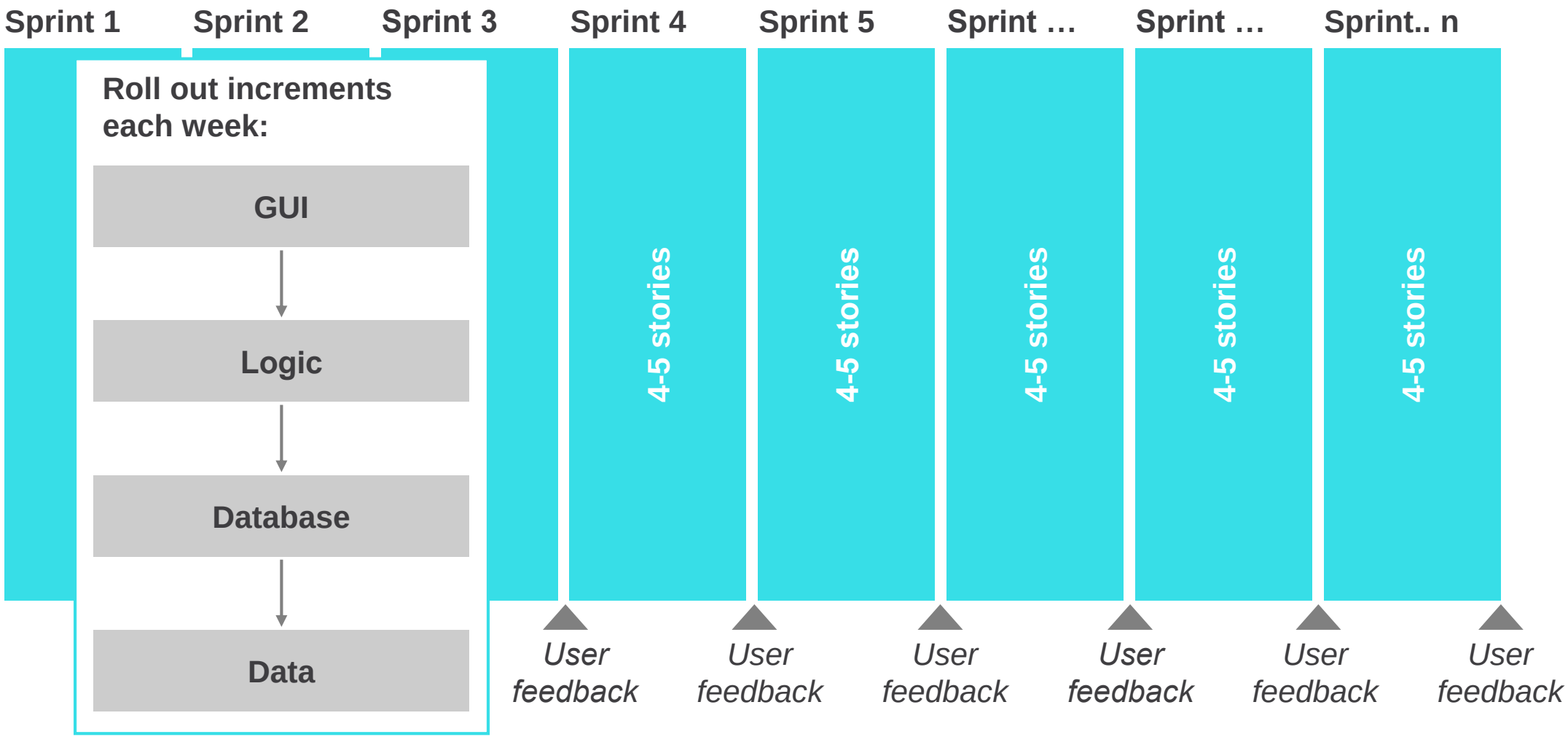
4 With a focus on incremental development to release working software frequently using a single-piece flow



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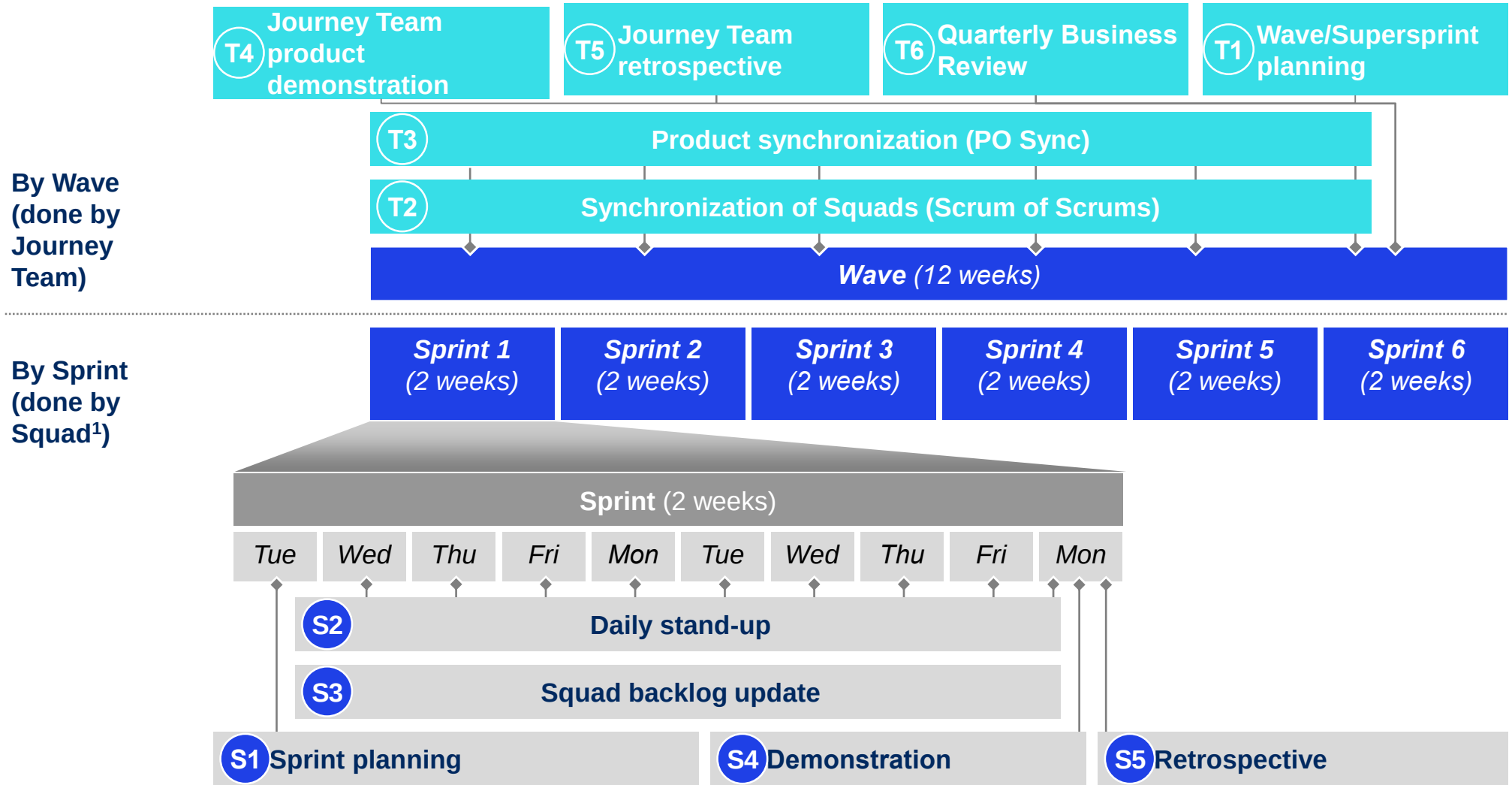
There are agile ceremonies that are done each Wave and during each Sprint



1 If there are multiple Squads in a Journey Team

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Squad level ceremonies

Ceremony	Frequency, duration	Participants	Agenda	Output
1 Sprint planning	▪ At sprint start	▪ Squad	▪ Review prioritized backlog (All) ▪ Elaborate stories (PO) ▪ Create sprint goal (Team) ▪ Estimate tasks (Team) ▪ Consider high-level design (Team)	▪ Sprint goal ▪ Sprint backlog ▪ Sprint plan
2 Daily standup	▪ Daily, 15 minutes (in the morning)	▪ Product owner to lead ▪ Squad ▪ Agile Coach at least once a week	▪ Status update – What I did yesterday? – What will I do today? – What impediments I face?	▪ Updated scrum board ▪ List of impediments to resolve
3 Squad backlog grooming	▪ On need basis	▪ PO – leading ▪ Tech Lead ▪ Other squad members/department representatives as needed	▪ Review and synchronization of squad backlogs ▪ Identify story dependencies ▪ Discuss new stories for the backlog ▪ Estimate new stories	▪ Re-prioritized product backlog ▪ More details and acceptance criteria in stories ▪ Prevent double work ▪ Ensure consistency across squad products
4 Sprint review / Demonstration	▪ At sprint end, 1 hour or any time, as needed	▪ Product owner to lead ▪ Squad ▪ Agile Coach ▪ SMEs and other stakeholders as needed	▪ Demonstrate the stories developed in the sprint (Team) ▪ Discuss feedback (All) ▪ Create new stories (PO) ▪ Update on release progress	▪ Signed off stories ▪ Improvements ▪ New stories
5 Retrospective	▪ After demo, 1 hour	▪ Agile Coach to lead ▪ Squad	▪ Discuss sprint (Team) ▪ Present sprint metrics (Head of TCJ) ▪ Identify good and bad parts of the sprint (Team) ▪ Identify actions for improvement (Team)	▪ Actions for improvement

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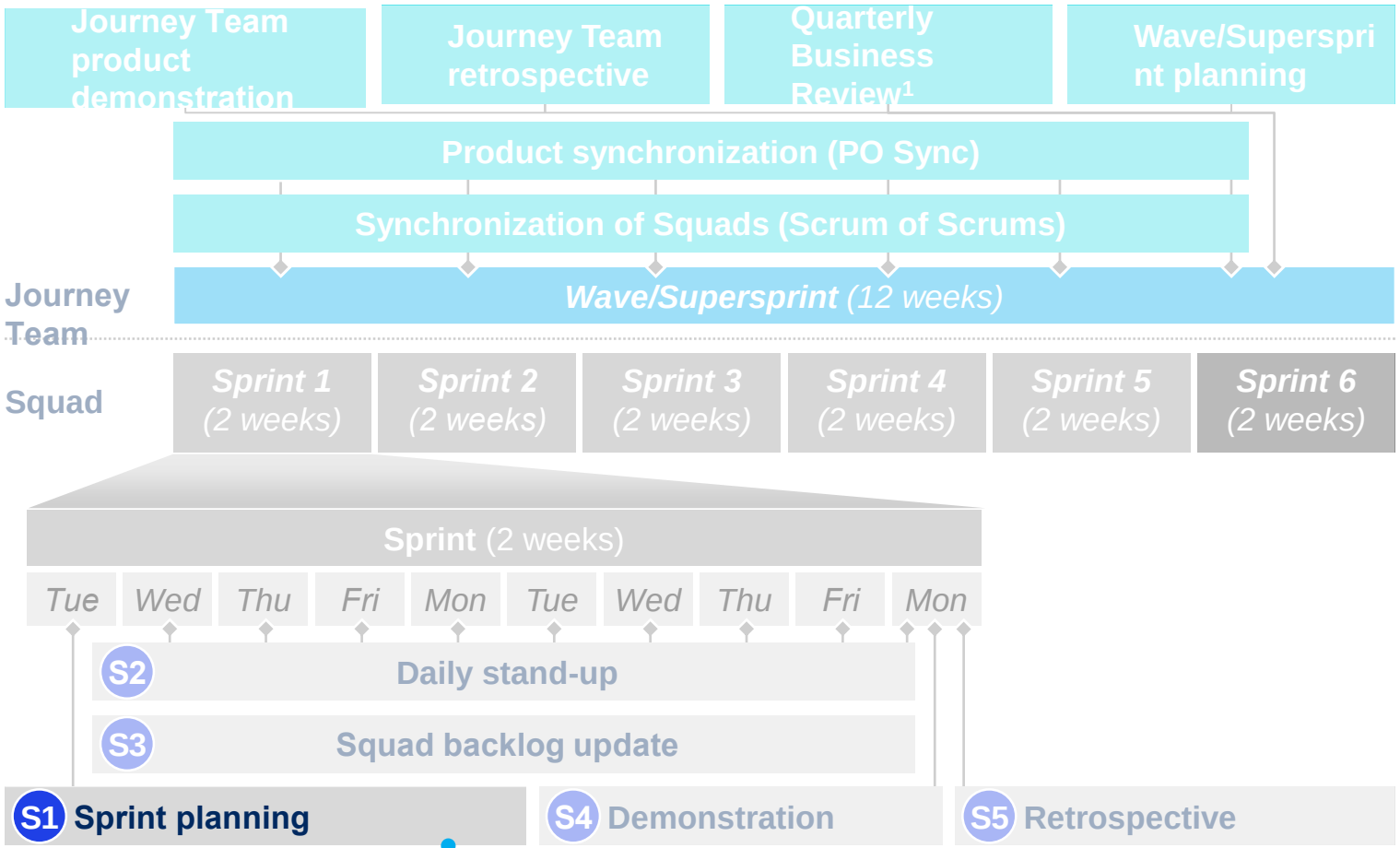
S1 Sprint planning

N Ceremony N



K1. Sprint planning

- A meeting on the first day of every sprint aimed at **defining the goal** and **backlog** of the current sprint
- **Duration:** ~2–4 h
- **Frequency:** once every sprint
- **Attendees:** Product Owner, Scrum Master, Squad

1 QBR – Quarterly Business Review

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S1 Sprint planning

Goal: Prepare the sprint backlog

Input information

- Contents of streams and Journey Team roadmap
- Squad backlog
- User stories/requirements planned for the sprint (reviewed against release goals and previous sprint feedback)
- Detailed service architecture
- Dependency board
- Published “definition of done” that team has agreed upon

Activities

- Define the sprint goal
- Product Owner clarifies user stories and detailed acceptance criteria, confirms each story meets definition of ready;
- Team divides stories into ½ day-1 day tasks
- Team members select user stories to work on, taking into account Definition of Done (DoD) and capacity
- Calibrate the backlog by comparing story effort and squad availability
- Identify what can be demoed at the end of the sprint

Deliverables

- Sprint backlog for the upcoming sprint
- Prioritized stories based on story complexity, dependencies, team availability, etc.
- Owners for each story in the sprint backlog

SOURCE: Foundations of Agile – Agile Ceremonies

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Sprint planning: Detailed preparation

Purpose

- The purpose of the sprint planning is first and foremost to secure that the **team, together prepares the backlog for the sprint. The sprint goal must be directly linked to the overall MVP**

Expected result

- **Sprint Backlog** is well described, user stories are estimated**, specific tasks are attached to every established user story** and the team agrees to solve all stories within the sprint

Preparation

- **The day before the sprint planning:** Based on the prior grooming, the Product Owner decides the goal for the coming sprint and assesses which user stories he will suggest to the team
- **The day before:** Product Owner assesses, whether all prioritized user stories are understood sufficiently and described from both a technical and business function perspective. If this is not the case, he clarifies the description in collaboration with e.g. Product Owner or one of the developers
- **Free choice:** Acceptance criteria can ease the work for the developers, however, close dialogue between Product Owner and developers about design and function often leads to better results and less rework

Execution

1. The Product Owner defines the overall purpose of the sprint, including themes the work should focus on during the sprint
2. Number of days/hours available during the sprint is to be decided
3. Product Owner introduces the user stories in a prioritized order, which he suggests for the coming sprint
4. The team will discuss each new user story:
   - Do we understand the purpose and the acceptance criteria?
   - How can it best be solved from a technical perspective?
   - Finalise the estimation
   - Can we solve this sprint, based on the team's historical productivity?
5. User stories selected by the teams move to the sprint Backlog
6. When the Sprint backlog has been created, new tasks are established for every single story in the sprint Backlog:
   - Tasks are specific assignments, which as a rule of thumb can be solved by a developer in 1 day or less
   - Since many user stories include several layers of architecture, at least one task needs to be established a day per layer
   - Free choice: The team can choose to estimate an expected number of hours per task. It will typically result in a higher value during the early sprints, where the productivity of the team is still unknown
   - User stories are assigned to squad members
   - Together the team agrees to solve all the user stories in the sprint Backlog, before the sprint ends
7. Just after the sprint planning, a stand-up often takes place, where the first tasks are delegated (see introduction for stand-up)
8. Product Owner establishes a Scrum board with all user stories and tasks in the sprint

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Before the first sprint planning session for a team, there would also be a “Lift off” session to discuss ways of working

Facilitator: Product Owner

Time box: 2 hours

Participants: Product Owner, Squad

When: Day 1

Purpose

- The purpose is to foster collaboration and encourage conversation amongst the team. Additionally, it is an opportunity to prepare the team with an over-view of the project, where Product Owner can provide a short product vision

Expected result

- **Squads orientated and decisions made about the working ways**

Preparation

- **None**

Execution

1. The team will introduce themselves to each other and mention the role that they are playing
2. The team will unpack the team values and what they stand for to form the culture of your team, and to have something to refer to if things get rocky down the road. It can also be beneficial for the team to list/discuss the set of values it will follow, such as the Scrum Values: to be committed, open, collaborative, to show respect, etc.
3. It is necessary to understand each person’s working arrangements to assist the team in getting the work done and staying happy in the process. For example, is everyone available for the daily stand-up, does everyone work the same core working hours, etc
4. The team must agree on how they are going to manage the work during a sprint.
5. The types of questions you can raise are:
   - Will they use a physical or a virtual story board
   - If it will be a virtual board, what will they use, e.g., JIRA, Excel, Confluence
   - For conference calls, should the team not be co-located, will they be using Skype for Business or teleconference
   - It should also be important to address what time the meetings will be held
   - If the team is meeting in a particular location, does everyone have access to parking and the building?

Prior to the team starting the work, it will be necessary to ensure that everyone has the correct access to any system, application, repository, etc.

6. The team needs to set the duration of the sprint and the start date
7. At the same time, the team will need to agree on the day, time and location for your Sprint Planning, Sprint Show-and-Tell, Sprint Retrospective, the Backlog Grooming and your Daily Stand-ups. Each event is a time-boxed event and must strictly adhere to the time limits to ensure the team stays focused and on track

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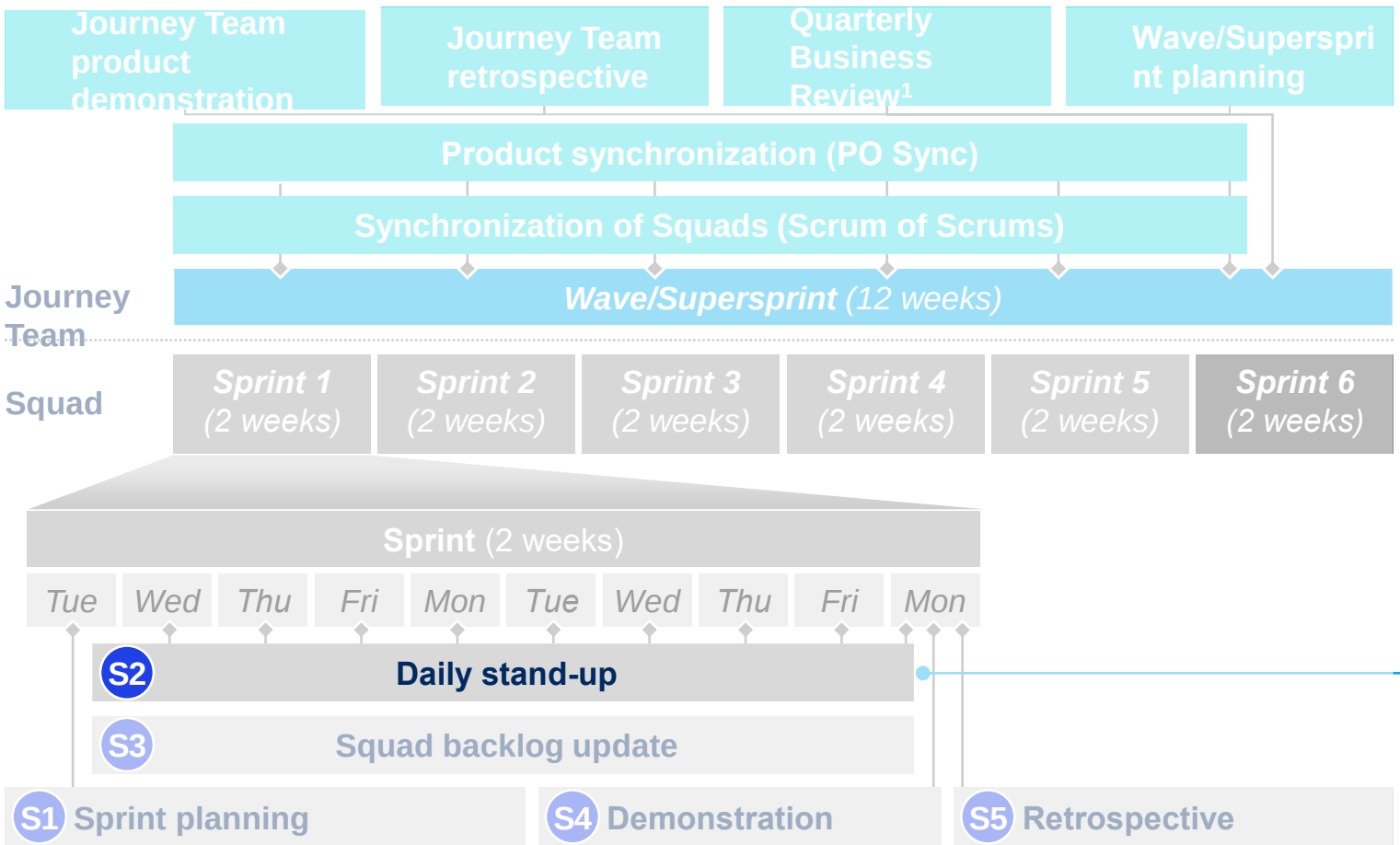
S2 Daily stand-up



S2. Daily stand-up

- A meeting of Squad Members, Scrum Master, and Product Owner for **daily planning** and **problem identification**
- **Duration:** 15 min.
- **Frequency:** Daily
- **Attendees:** Scrum Master, Squad, Product Owner

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S2 Daily stand-up

Goal: synchronize work, plan for the day and identify any encountered issues; understand progress toward the sprint goals

Input information

- Sprint backlog
- Dependency board

Activities

- Members share:
  - What did I do yesterday?
  - What do I plan to do today?
  - What impediments do I have?
- Identify issues that should be raised at the Scrum of Scrums
- Each Squad member records on the Task Board (analog or electronic) the change of status of her or his tasks

Deliverables

- Plans for the day
- List of issues and plans to address them

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SOURCE: Foundations of Agile – Agile Ceremonies

Daily stand-up : Detailed guide

Facilitator: Product Owner

Time box: 10-15 min

Participants: Product Owner, Squad

When: Every morning

Purpose

- In the daily stand-up, **the status of the sprint progress is assessed** and possible impediments are identified

Expected result

- Status of all **user stories and tasks are updated,** everyone leaves the meeting with **one or more tasks assigned,** and all current impediments are surfaced

Preparation

- **Just before stand-up:** All members of the Squad ensure that they know the relation between the tasks they are working on (or just completed) and user stories - in order to proceed quickly and effectively in the stand-up
- **Just before the stand-up or the day before:** Product Owner ensures that all user stories and tasks are placed correctly on the Scrum board, meaning:
  - Tasks are placed on the same row as the user stories to which they belong

Execution

1. All members of the Squad (developers, architects, testers) gather in a semicircle around the Scrum board
2. The Product Owner addresses all team members one by one, and all answer the same three questions:
   i. What did you do yesterday?
   ii. What will you do today?
   iii. Is there anything, that prevents you from completing your tasks?
3. While the team members answer the first question, they update the status of tasks by moving them horizontally across the Scrum board, e.g. from ”in progress” to ”ready for test” (where relevant)
4. During the answering of the second question, the team members take one task from the board’s first column (”to-do” or ”Backlog”), write their name on it, and move it to the ”in progress” column ((where relevant and if they do not have any tasks left from the day before)
5. Through the third question, impediments are identified. It is decided who team members need to talk to, to remove the barrier but the problem solving itself does not take place until after the stand-up
6. Towards the end of the sprint: If there are still tasks and user stories, that have not been started, the Product Owner goes through all unsolved issues on a daily basis, and asks the team if it is possible for anyone to take on an extra task before the sprint closes

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S3 Squad backlog grooming

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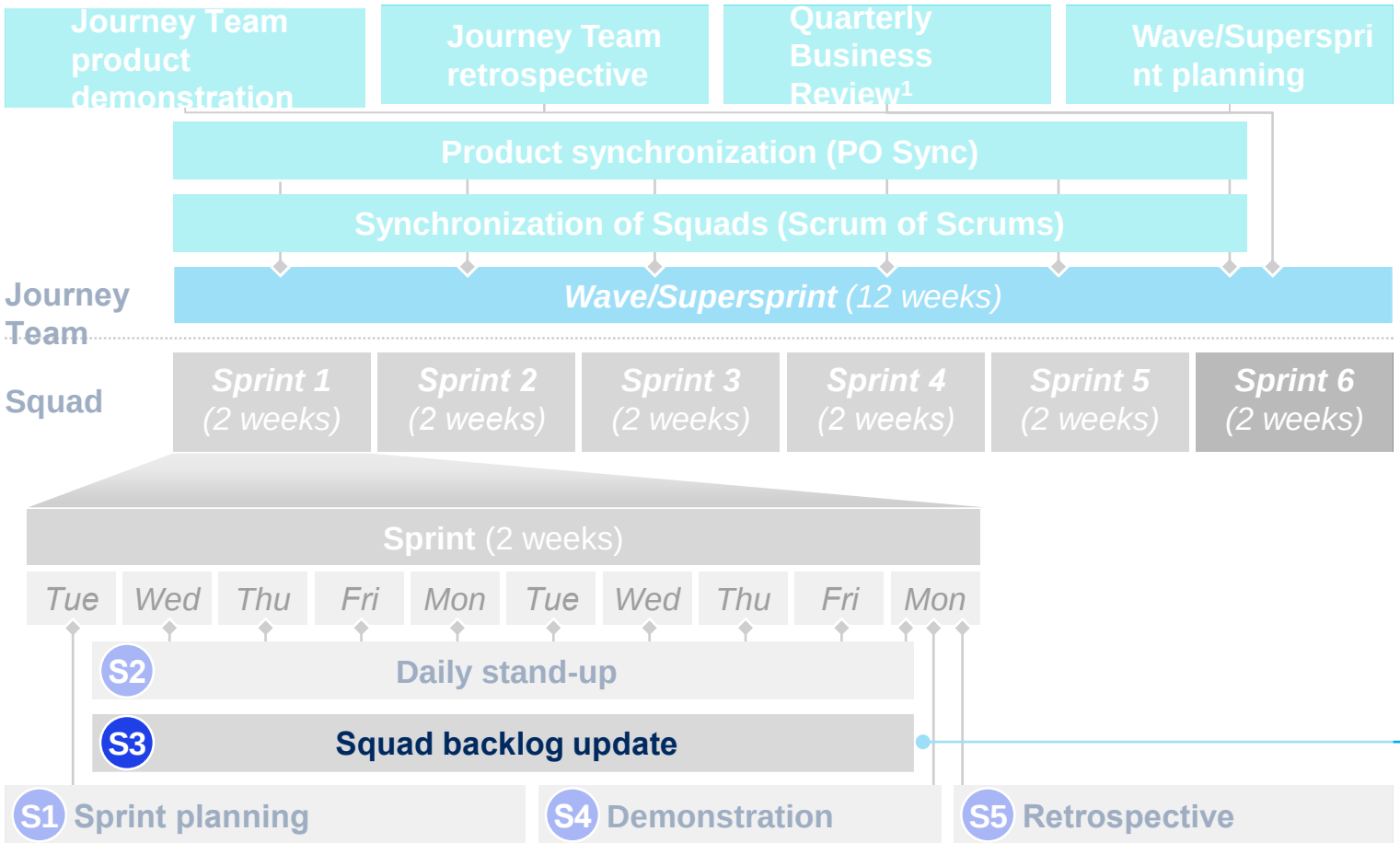

S3. Squad backlog grooming

- The day-to-day process of keeping the backlog up to date with a regular meeting of the Product Owner and Squad members to **prepare for planning** the next sprint
- **Duration:** 1 h
- **Frequency:** once every sprint
- **Attendees:** Product Owner, Scrum Master, Squad

1 QBR – Quarterly Business Review

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S3 Squad backlog grooming

Goal: prepare for planning of the next sprint

Input information

- Contents of streams and Journey Team roadmap
- Squad backlog
- Dependency board
- Detailed service architectures

Activities

- Product owner discusses feedback from sprint review and user feedback
- Product owner updates and prioritizes user stories, discusses new stories and their inclusion into the squad backlog
- Development team gains clarity from PO on new/updated stories and discusses implementation options
- Development team estimates effort and value of backlog items
- Team make decisions about removing or splitting backlog items

Deliverables

- Updated and expanded Squad backlog

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SOURCE: Foundations of Agile – Agile Ceremonies

We must follow 4 key steps during the Backlog grooming ceremony

ILLUSTRATIVE

Steps for managing a backlog

1. prioritize user stories in order from most to least critical from a business value perspective

2. Identify technical or business dependencies between prioritized capabilities

3. Reprioritize, if needed, based on dependencies

4. Review the release plan and adapt if required

Example backlog

No	Case Type	Epic	Display as	User Story	Short Description	Acceptance Criteria
1	New Account Processing	Archive Case	Primary Path	As the system admin, I want to save the image and notes so that we meet regulatory archival requirements.	Archive Case	**Given** that I am logged into the application **When** I upload an image and notes **then** the files are saved in a regulatory archival storage
5	New Account Processing	Check for Duplicate Case	Integration	As the system admin I would like to send the information to our primary server so that the 5 most recently created accounts can be opened	Check for Duplicate Case	**Given** that I have the PII, **When** I am leverage the case matching scoring mechanism **then** I am able to use and retrieve the 5 most recently created accounts
6	New Account Processing	Check for Linking Requirements	Decision	As the system admin, I would like to determine if there are any associated case types so that the appropriate sub case can be created	Check for Linking Requirements	**Given** that I have access to associated case types **When** I want to determine if there are case types associated with the case, **Then** the appropriate sub case can be created
7	New Account Processing	Collect Missing Information and Documents	Alternate Path	As the Processor, I want to retrieve missing information, so that the information can be validated.	Collect Missing Information and Documents	**Given** that I have access to information retrieval, **When** I try to retrieve missing information, **Then** I can retrieve it and validate it

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S4 Demonstration (sprint review)

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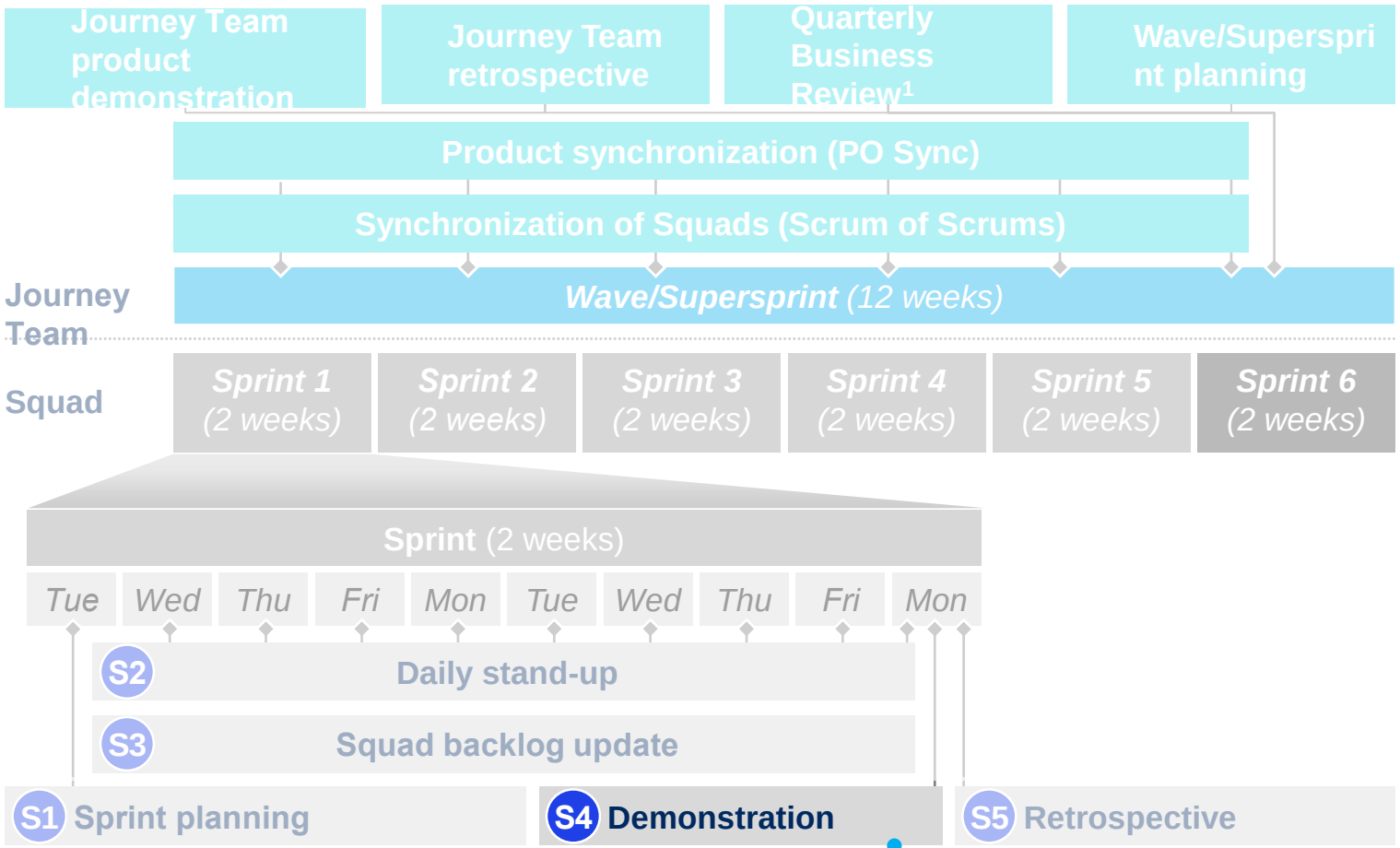

S4. Demonstration

- A meeting of Squad Members and any other stakeholders to **demonstrate the squad product** created during the current sprint
- **Duration:** 2–4 h
- **Frequency:** once every sprint
- **Attendees:** Squad, Product Owner, Scrum Master, all stakeholders (optional)

1 QBR – Quarterly Business Review

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S4 Demonstration (sprint review)

Goal: Demonstrate the working product, confirm the achievement of the sprint goal, gather feedback on the work completed

Input information

- Sprint backlog
- Sprint result

Activities

- Demonstrate sprint deliverables – “what can the product do now that it couldn’t two weeks ago”
- Seek feedback from users and stakeholders
- Review end of sprint metrics to track progress against the release goals:
  - Burn down: Are we on target with the release date?
  - Burn up: Is our scope increasing?
  - Velocity: Are we building a quality product?
  - Quality/No of defects:Are we improving as a team?
- Generate proposals for improvement on sprint deliverables; update or change backlog accordingly

Deliverables

- Feedback for the Squad
- Expansion and revision of the Squad backlog
- Release (not every Sprint)

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SOURCE: Foundations of Agile – Agile Ceremonies

Sprint Review: Detailed preparation guide

1. The Product Owner makes administrative arrangements for the review -- reserving the conference rooms, arranging for refreshments, getting additional presentation aids (projectors, whiteboards, flip charts, etc.).
2. The Product Owner makes sure key business stakeholders are available to attend and confirm and assess the product or product increment. Invitee list should include
   - All project team members
   - Digital Organization leadership
   - Site leadership
   - Site stakeholders
   - Selected end users (user council members, if established)
   - Anyone interested in the project

- The demonstration should include:
  - State the Sprint Goal to create the context for your team's Show and Tell.
  - Share the User Stories included in the Sprint.
  - Demonstrate completed stories from the view of an end user (explain all assumptions and User Stories, don't just jump in without context).
    - Transition to a live demo of what is now working as a result of this sprint
      - If not software, be creative in how to visualize work product from user perspective
  - Refer back to Release Plan to show indicate overall status.
  - Specifically review key decisions and why they were made.
  - Highlight problems experienced in the Sprint.
  - Discuss User Stories that were added during the Sprint and why they were added.

- **Impact KPI's:** Present an update on impact KPI's that the project is committed to influence
  - If the project is not yet impacting these KPI's, present the current value as a baseline
- **Agile Metrics:** Present and interpret three key agile metrics charts
  - Velocity Chart
  - Release Burndown Charts
    - For each in-progress release
  - Epic Burndown Charts
    - For each in-progress epic

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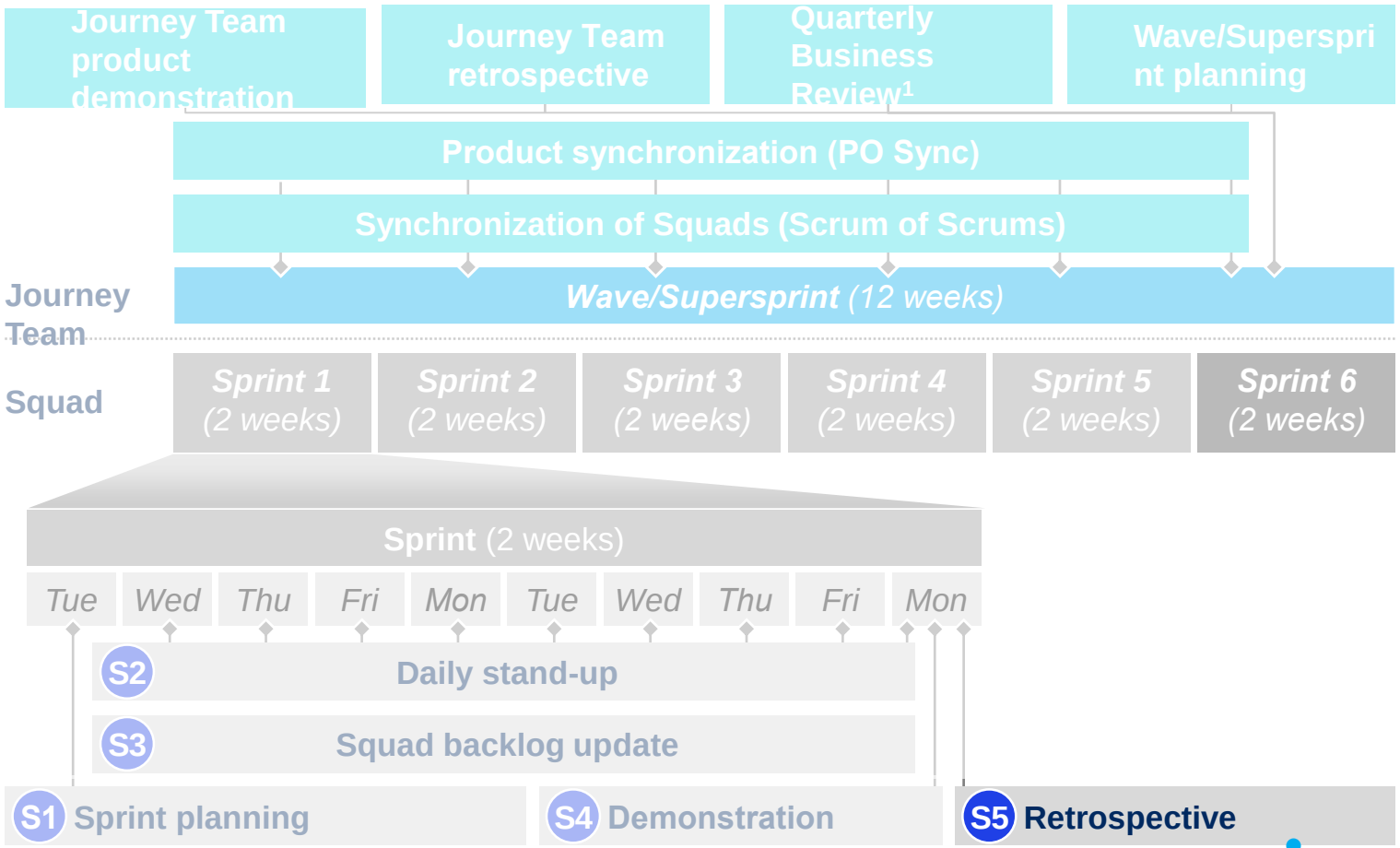
S5 Retrospective



S5. Retrospective

- A meeting of **Squad Members, Product Owner, Scrum Master,** and **Agile Coach** to discuss **improvements in Squad workflow** and identify **impediments to productivity**
- **Duration:** 2 h
- **Frequency:** once every sprint
- **Attendees:** Product Owner, Scrum Master, Squad

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S5 Retrospective

Goal: Improve squad workflow, identify impediments, develop and plan corrective actions.

Input information

- Problems and difficulties in Squad activities identified during the sprint

Activities

- Team discusses:
  - Stay: what is working well,
  - Change: what is not working well
  - Start: what we need to do to get better
- Analysis of sprint success in regard to people, relations among them, processes and tools
- Identifying positive and negative factors of Squad's performance
- Developing a plan to implement improvements to the Squad workflow

Deliverables

- Squad performance improvement plan

SOURCE: Foundations of Agile – Agile Ceremonies

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Sprint retrospective: Detailed guide

Facilitator: Product Owner

Time box: 60 min

Participants: Product Owner, Squad, Head of DF

When: Last day in sprint

Purpose

- A meeting where the squad discusses the just-concluded sprint and determines any changes to improve the next sprint. Looks at the “how” or squad delivery process and way of working.

Expected result

- Each impediment, hampering the team's productivity in the finished sprint, is matched with identified **concrete solutions**
- Options for **optimizing the sprint process** are identified and all team members give their views on possible solutions

Preparation

- **Before Retrospective:** Pull JIRA sprint report and discuss with the team

Execution

1. Retrospective activities focus on continuous improvement and try to address three main questions/points through discussion:
   - What went well during the sprint cycle?
   - What went wrong during the sprint cycle?
   - What could we do differently to improve?

   These questions aim to look ahead to mitigate possible risks or concerns . Example Topics include: Milestones, dependencies, motivations, misunderstandings, processes, etc.
2. Product Owner sums up productivity in the just completed sprint on user story level: How many user stories did the team commit to in the last sprint planning (maybe divided into architectural layers) and how many stories were actually completed? **Practical:** Product Owner refers to poster or whiteboard, where the number of committed, completed and non-completed user stories are listed
3. Product Owner asks each developer in turn: Which user stories or tasks have you finished? Are there any other user stories or tasks you have begun or committed yourself to, but not completed? Were there any concrete barriers that prevented you from getting further in the process? **Practical:** Developers refer to the poster with all user stories in the sprint
4. For each impediment identified, Product Owner asks team: What can we do to remove this impediment? **Practical:** Product Owner notes impediments and solutions on paper/in Excel
5. Finally Product Owner shows the team's productivity in terms of story points, including points closed in the last sprint, points closed in previous sprints and points back in the product Backlog. **Practical:** Product Owner refers to the poster with the burn down chart.
6. Until next retrospective: Product Owner follows up with individual developers and ensure that the identified barriers are remedied. Product Owner is responsible for activating all the forces in and outside the team, that may be needed to remove barriers

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J Journey Team level ceremonies – 6 typically used ceremonies

Ceremony	Frequency, duration	Participants	Agenda	Objective
1 Wave/Supersprint planning	▪ Once every Wave/Supersprint ▪ ~8-16h	▪ Sponsor, Journey Team Lead, Program Manager, all Journey Team members and other stakeholders identified during preparations	▪ Ensure a common understanding of the tasks and goals of Wave/Supersprint; its result is an approved set of goals for the Wave/Supersprint.	▪ Set the goals and backlog for the next Wave/Supersprint, Squads to plan how to implement the Wave/Supersprint backlog and achieve its goals
2 Synchronization of Squads	▪ Daily to once a week ▪ 15-30min	▪ Scrum Masters of the Journey Team and Squads, Journey Team Architect, other stakeholders (as needed)	▪ Discussion of dependent work, development of general approach and implementation plan ▪ Identification of negative dependencies, developing solutions to resolve them	▪ Status and coordination of activities on related features and stories of several Squads, system solution to Squads' organizational and process issues
3 Product synchronization	▪ Min. 1/sprint ▪ ~1h	▪ Product Owners, Scrum Masters (as needed), Journey Team Lead, Journey Team Architect, other Journey Team members as needed	▪ Product Owners and Journey Team Lead updating backlog and roadmap (parsing of dependencies, prioritization of epics/features,…)	▪ Update synchronized product roadmaps (Journey Team roadmap) to plan further activities of Squads and Journey Teams
4 Journey Team product demonstration	▪ Once every Wave/Supersprint ▪ ~4h	▪ Journey Team Lead, Journey Team Scrum Masters, Product Owners, stakeholders and interested parties	▪ Review of the current Wave/Supersprint goals ▪ Demonstration of Wave/Supersprint results ▪ Questions and comments	▪ Demonstrate Wave/Supersprint results to all stakeholders
5 Journey Team retrospective	▪ Once every Wave/Supersprint ▪ ~2-4h	▪ Journey Team Lead, Journey Team Scrum Masters, Agile Coach (as needed), Product Owners	▪ Analysis of Wave/Supersprint success with regard to people, relations among them, processes and tools ▪ Identifying positive and negative factors of Journey Team's performance	▪ Ensure continuous improvement of Journey Team workflow
6 QBR market	▪ Once every Wave/Supersprint (end of) ▪ 1-2 working days	▪ Sponsor, Leads of all the Sponsor's Journey Teams, Program Managers (as needed)	▪ Discussing past results. plans and goals going forward ▪ Updating long-term plans of 6 Wave/Supersprints	▪ Transparent discussion on results ▪ Planning of next 6 Wave/Supersprints ▪ Planning of streams for the next Wave/Supersprint and their prioritization

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J1 Wave / Wave/Supersprint planning

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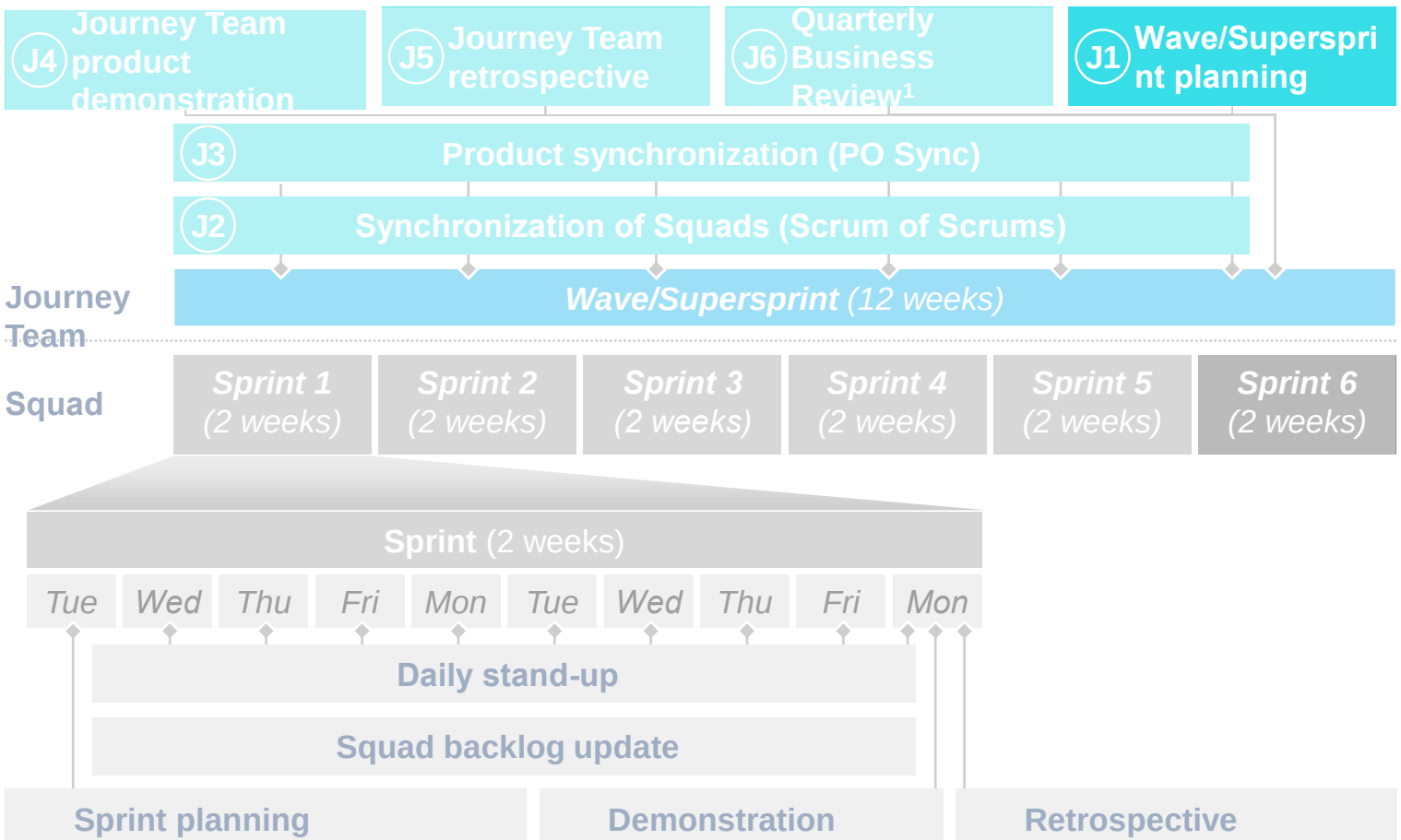

J1. Wave/Supersprint planning

- A meeting of a Journey Team with a model agenda **to ensure a common understanding of the tasks and goals of Wave/Supersprint;** its result is an approved set of goals for the Wave/Supersprint.
- **Duration:** ~8–16 hours
- **Frequency:** Once every Wave/Supersprint
- **Attendees:** Sponsor, Journey Team Lead, Program Manager, all Journey Team members and other stakeholders identified during preparations for the event

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J1 Wave / Wave/Supersprint planning

Goal: set the goal and backlog for the next Wave/Supersprint, Squads to plan how to implement the Wave/Supersprint backlog and achieve its goals

Input information

- Strategic Themes
- Product(s) vision and description of Journey Team streams
- Contents of Journey Team streams and Journey Team roadmap
- Backlogs of Journey Team Squads
- Prototype of dependency board for the next Wave/Supersprint

Activities

- Presentation of business context (Sponsor), Journey Team vision (Journey Team Lead) and target architecture (Journey Team Architect – if exists).
- Identification/specification of dependencies and assistance in factoring them into Wave/Supersprint execution
- Planning of implementation and synchronization with related systems
- Comparing and balancing demand and effort capacity
- Setting of Wave/Supersprint goal(s)
- Confirmation of Wave/Supersprint backlog from all Squads

Deliverables

- Goal(s) of the upcoming Wave/Supersprint
- Wave/Supersprint board (incl. delivery dates of new epics \ features, dependencies, relevant milestones)
- Updated Journey Team roadmap
- Wave/Supersprint backlog

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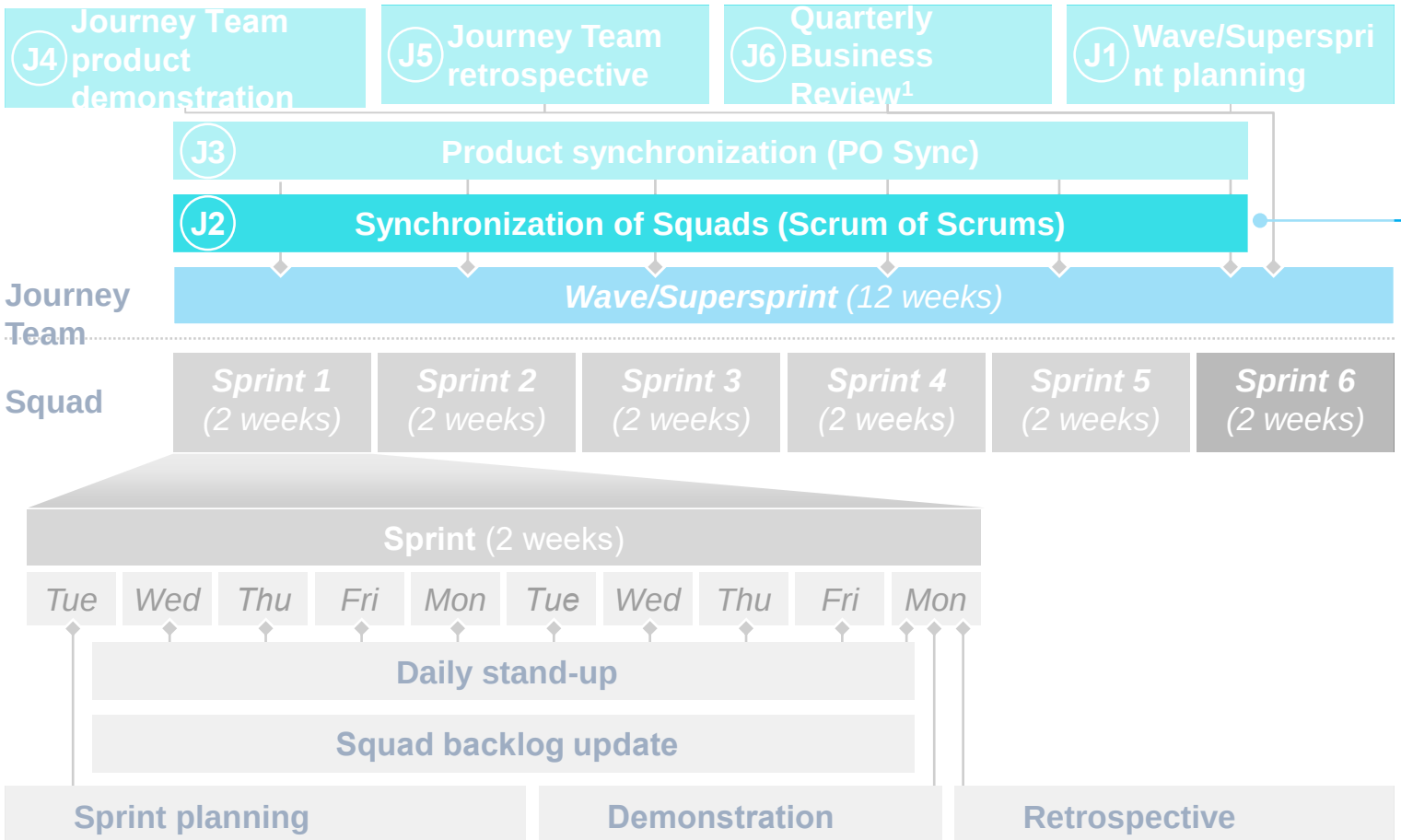
J2 Synchronization of Squads (Scrum of Scrums)



J2. Synchronization of Squads (Scrum of Scrums)

- Meeting of **Squad Scrum Masters** with the Journey Team **Architect** and **members of Squads** and other members of the Journey Team as needed
- Critical for **coordination of Squads** working on the same platform or on the same product for **synchronization of releases** and **dependency management**
- **Duration:** ~15-30 min
- **Frequency:** From daily to once a week
- **Attendees:** Scrum Masters of the Journey Team and Squads, Journey Team Architect, other stakeholders involved in Wave (as needed; e.g., Channel)

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J2 Synchronization of Squads (Scrum of Scrums)

Goal: status and coordination of activities on related features and stories of several Squads, system solution to Squads' organizational and process issues

Input information

- Wave/Supersprint backlog
- Backlogs of Squads
- Dependency board
- Results of Squad retrospectives (as needed)

Activities

- Discussion of dependent work, development of general approach and implementation plan
- Identification of negative dependencies, developing solutions to resolve them

Deliverables

- Proposals for updating the Wave/Supersprint/sprint backlog
- Updated dependency board
- List of decisions/actions/assignments

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J3 Product synchronization (PO Sync)

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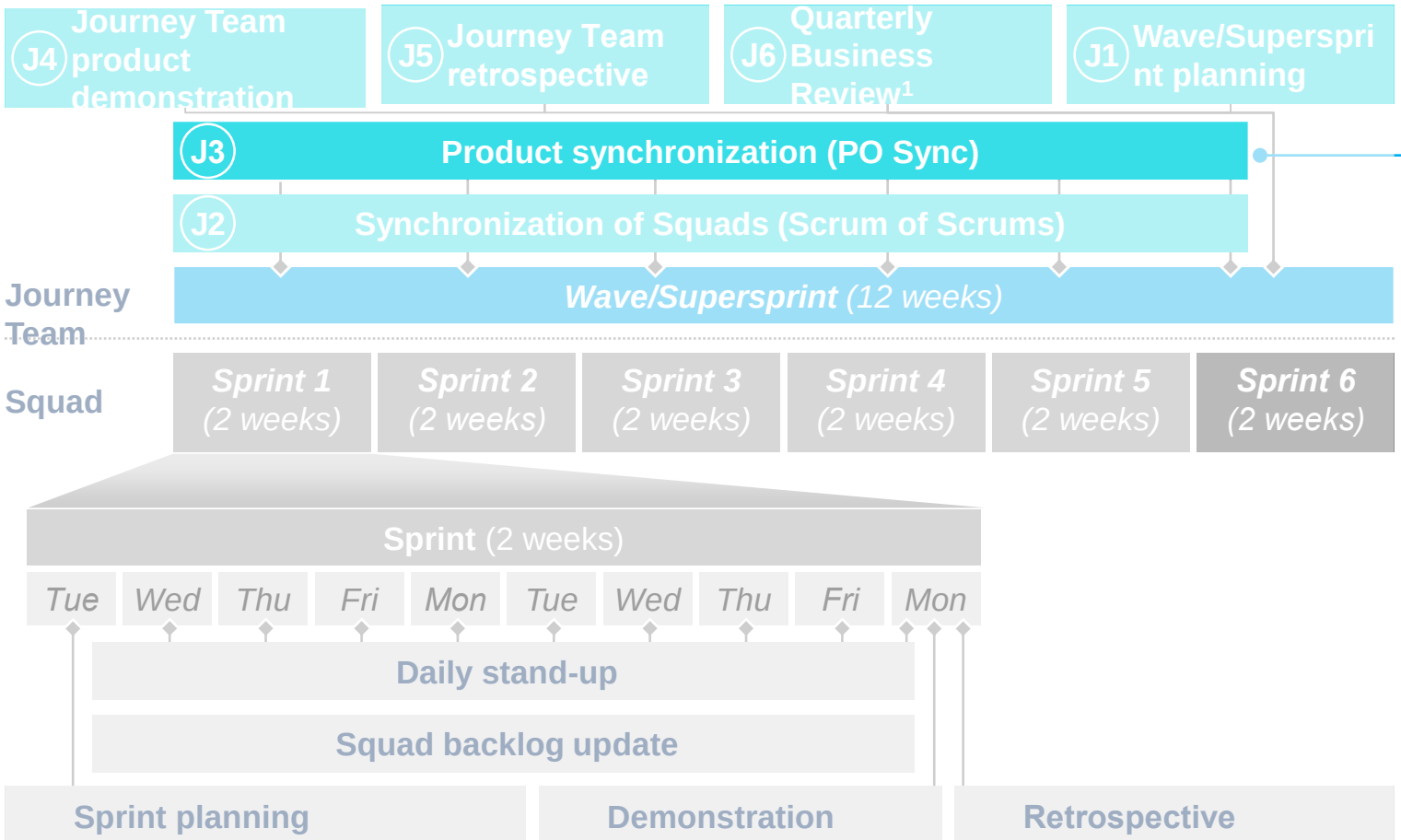

J3. Product synchronization (PO Sync)

- A meeting of Product Owners and Journey Teamr Lead aimed at keeping the Journey Team backlog and roadmap up to date
- **Duration:** ~1 hour
- **Frequency:** At least once every sprint
- **Attendees:** Product Owners of all Squads, Scrum Masters of Squads (as needed), Journey Team Lead, Journey Team Scrum Master, Journey Team Architect, Chapter/Competency Leads (as needed), Agile Coach (as needed)

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J3 Product synchronization (PO Sync)

Goal: update synchronized product roadmaps (Journey Team roadmap) to plan further activities of Squads and whole Journey Team

Input information

- Vision of product and description of streams
- Conceptual architecture of the product / function area
- Contents of streams and Journey Team roadmap
- Backlogs of Squads
- Dependency board

Activities

- Presentation and discussion of plans for products/streams
- Parsing of dependencies among products, designing measures to resolve negative dependencies
- End-to-end prioritization of Journey Team epics and features, synchronization of priorities in Squads backlogs, synchronization of development times for dependent tasks in the future Wave/Supersprints
- Ensuring a uniform UX approach to Squad activities
- Iteratively determining the composition of the next Wave/Supersprint
- Defining the architectural component of the roadmap

Deliverables

- Synchronized Squads backlogs
- General solutions to resolve negative dependencies
- Updated dependency board
- Architectural part of the roadmap

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SOURCE: Foundations of Agile – Agile Ceremonies

J4 Journey Team product demonstration

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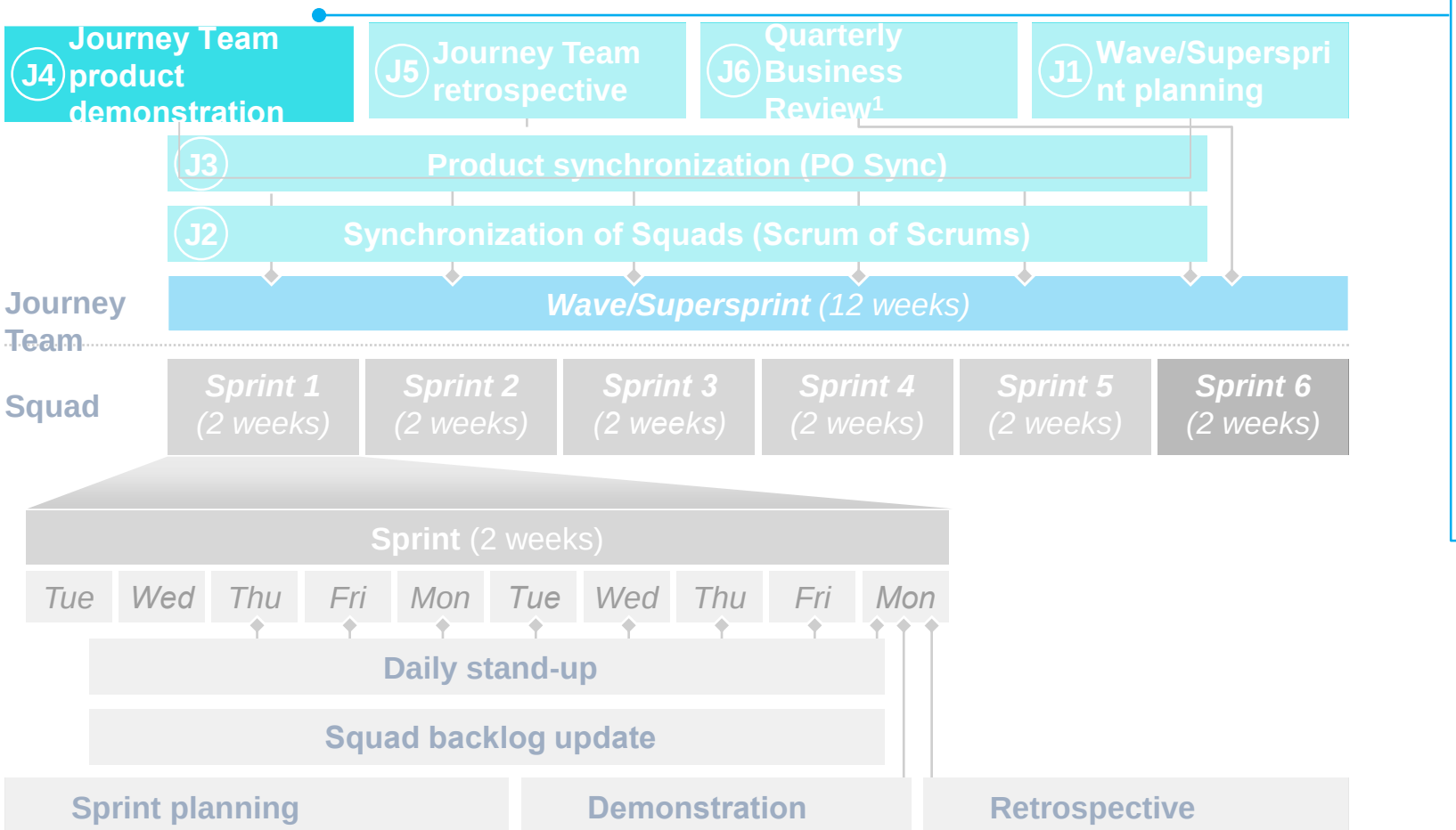

J4. Journey Team product demonstration

- One of the most important regular Journey Team events held during the **last sprint** of a Wave/Supersprint; involves a **demonstration** of the **results** of the entire Journey Team to stakeholders
- **Duration:** ~2-4 h
- **Frequency:** Once every Wave/Supersprint
- **Attendees:** Journey Team Lead, Journey Team Scrum Master, Product Owners, Scrum Masters, representatives of Squads (as needed), stakeholders and interested parties

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J4 Journey Team product demonstration

Goal: demonstrate Wave/Supersprint results to all stakeholders

Input information

- Strategic Themes
- Wave/Supersprint backlog
- Wave/Supersprint result

Activities

- Review of the current Wave/Supersprint goals
- Demonstration of Wave/Supersprint results
- Questions and comments
- Generalization of current status, feedback, ideas for the backlog and further actions

Deliverables

- Feedback for the Journey Team

SOURCE: Foundations of Agile – Agile Ceremonies

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J5 Journey Team retrospective

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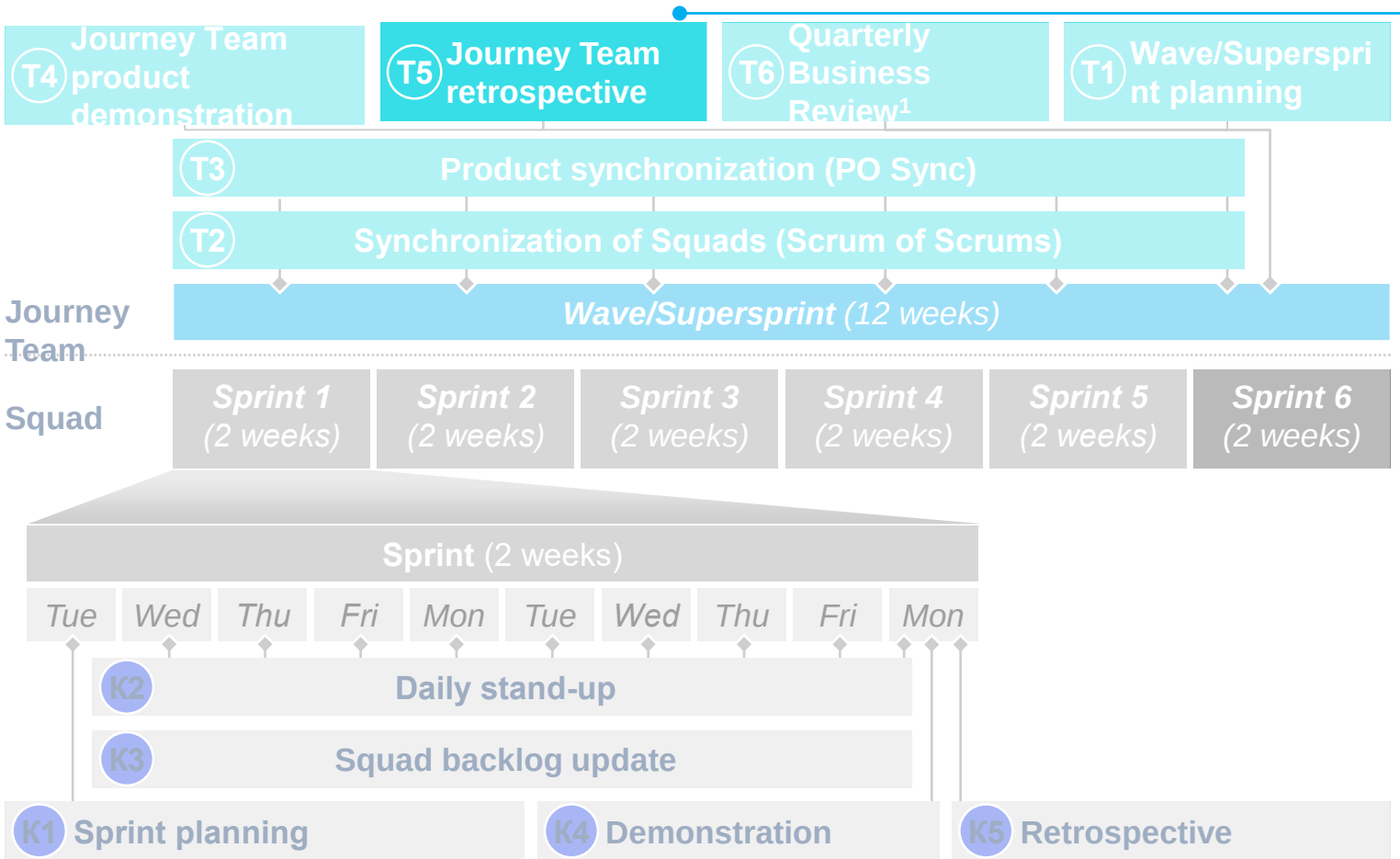

J5. Journey Team retrospective

- A meeting of Journey Team Members aimed at **improving Journey Team workflow**, identifying **impediments**, framing and planning **actions to correct them**
- **Duration:** ~2–4 h
- **Frequency:** Once every Wave/Supersprint
- **Attendees:** Journey Team Lead, Journey Team Scrum Master, Agile Coach (as needed), Product Owners, Scrum Masters, representatives of Squads (as needed)

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J5 Journey Team retrospective

Goal: ensure continuous improvement of Journey Team workflow

Input information

- Problems and difficulties in Journey Team activities identified during the Wave/Supersprint
- Feedback based on demonstration

Activities

- Analysis of Wave/Supersprint success with regard to people, relations among them, processes and tools
- Identifying positive and negative factors of Journey Team's performance
- Workshop to develop solutions to Journey Team's problems

Deliverables

- Journey Team performance improvement plan
- Performance improvement plans for other Journey Teams and other parts of the organization

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SOURCE: Foundations of Agile – Agile Ceremonies

J6 Quarterly Business Review[1]

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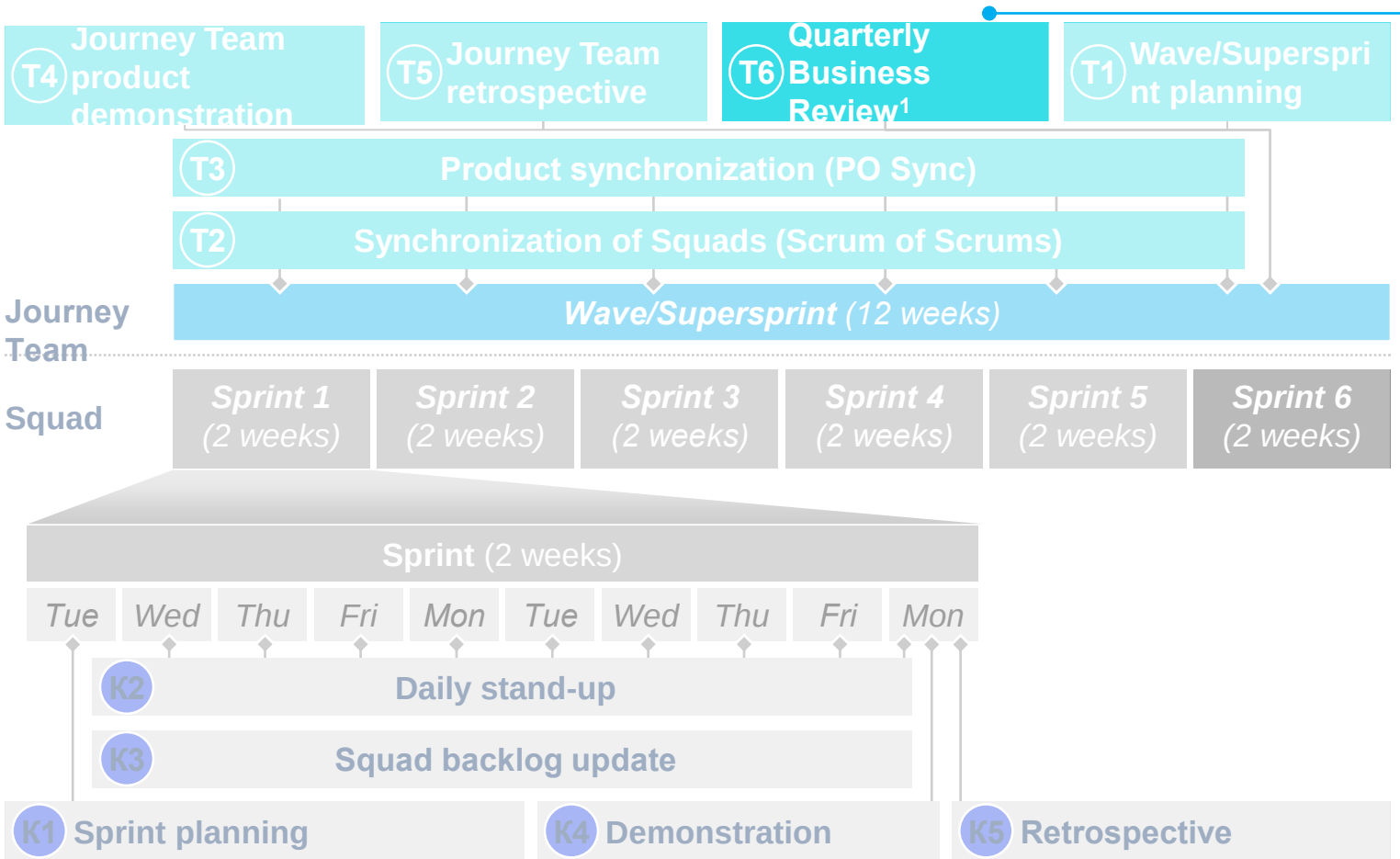

T6. Quarterly Business Review[1]

- A meeting of **Sponsor** and **Leads of all his Journey Teams** to discuss Journey Teams **deliverables** in the **previous quarter** and Journey Teams **plans** for the **next quarter**
- **Duration:** ~1-2 working days.
- **Frequency:** Once every Wave/Supersprint
- **Attendees:** Sponsor, Leads of all the Sponsor's Journey Teams, Program Managers (as needed)

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J6 Quarterly Business Review (Quarterly Business Review)

Goal:
- Discussion of Wave/Supersprint results
- Planning of next 6 Wave/Supersprints
- Planning of streams for the next Wave/Supersprint and their prioritization

Input information
- Journey Team Lead creates the Quarterly Business Review (QBR) document, which summarizes the results of the last Wave/Supersprint and describes the goals for the next Wave/Supersprint:
  - Strategic Themes
  - Journey Team streams and their key Wave/Supersprint indicators
  - Implemented Wave/Supersprint backlog
  - Demonstration results
  - Goals and backlog of the Wave/Supersprint and the next 5 Wave/Supersprints
- The document is first discussed with Journey Team Squads, Leads of other Journey Teams and Program Sponsors (as needed)

Activities
- Discussing results and plans with the Journey Team Sponsor and other Journey Team Leads and Program Sponsors (as needed) supplementing streams in other Journey Teams, supplementing program streams, prioritizing streams.
- Updating long-term plans of 6 Wave/Supersprints

Deliverables
- Prioritized contents of Journey Team streams for the next Wave/Supersprint and plans of their implementation
- Preliminary backlog of epics for 6 Wave/Supersprints
- Allocation of resources and budgets

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